

Our Mission Statement

To facilitate the successful integration of individuals & communities of non-English speaking background, into Australian life, in an environment sensitive & responsive to their needs

OFFICE LOCATIONS

LOCATION	POSTAL ADDRESS	PHONE	FAX	EMAIL
HAMILTON (Head Office) 8 Chaucer Street Hamilton NSW 2303	As location	4969 3399	4961 4997	nss@nsservices.com.au
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ARMIDALE Hughes House 141 Faulkner Street Armidale NSW 2350	PO Box 1781 Armidale NSW 2350	6771 3975	6771 3691	nssarm@nsservices.com.au
TAMWORTH Suite 10 56-58 Dowe Street Tamworth NSW 2340	As location	6766 5070	Not avail.	nsstam@nsservices.com.au

SERVICE REGIONS

Hunter Outreach – Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens, Maitland, Cessnock, Singleton, Muswellbrook, Dungog, Scone, Merriwa & Murrurundi.

Central Coast – Gosford & Wyong

Northern Tablelands – Tamworth & Armidale

Other Regions Supported – North West & Central West NSW

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Board of Management - 30 June 2015

Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM	Chair, Audit Committee
Mr Jon Chin	Deputy Chair
Ms Christine Jordan	Treasurer, Public Officer, Audit Committee
Mr James Garvey	Assistant Treasurer, Audit Committee
Ms Anna Marendy	Secretary
Ms Denise Hodgson	Assistant Secretary
Mr Zoran Vasiljevic	Director
Ms Sania Young	Director
Father Nicholas Zervas OAM	Director
Ms Georgina Ramsay	Director
Mr Biko Syongoh	Director
Ms Ewa Korzinsky	Director
Cr. Therese Doyle	Co-opted Member, Newcastle City Council
Barney Langford	Co-opted Member, Lake Macquarie City Council

Staff – 30 June 2015

Chief Executive Officer**Lulu Tantos**

Operations Manager
 Migration Agents
 Finance Manager
 Finance Officer
 Administration
 WH&S Officer
 Office Manager – Central Coast
 Administration – Central Coast

Enza Di Stefano
 Lulu Tantos & Henriette de Jong
 Kerry Blades
 Kathy Rowarth
 John Pattey & Natasha Holliday,
 Violeta Klements – (*Maternity Relief*)
 Helen Buchanan
 Keiko Clements
 Sharlene Huber

Rural Settlement Support Team Manager**Alex Burns**

Hunter Welfare Outreach SGP Worker
 New England SGP Worker - Tamworth
 New England SGP Worker - Armidale
 Central Coast SGP Worker

Rose Oku
 Amalin Sundaravej
 Judith Roberts
 Nellie Srisurapon

Settlement Support & Communities Team Manager**Alex Burns**

Settlement Grant Project Workers
 CALD Youth Worker - SGP
 Life Skills & Parenting Groups/ Refugee Programs Project Officer
 Congolese Family Support Worker
 Volunteers Coordinator (Educational Programs)
 Volunteers Coordinator (Welfare Programs)

Lydia Manusiu & Hayley Bateman
 Tonkoh Kamara
 Helen Buchanan
 Marie Zawadi
 Michael Freund
 Cassie Galliot

Aged Services Team Manager**Sue Hristov**

Multicultural Access Project Worker
 Home Care Packages Coordinators
 Hunter Multicultural Respite Service Coordinator
 Community Visitors Scheme Coordinator - Hunter
 Hunter Multicultural Social Support Project Worker
 Chinese Social Support Project Worker
 Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator – Central Coast
 Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator, Community Visitors
 Scheme Coordinator – Central Coast
 Multicultural Community Development Workers – Central Coast

Rasa Bajalis
 Tima 'Oto, Lupe Fonua
 Dominique Nyilas
 Irine Lupish
 Tima 'Oto
 Dongmei Zhang
 Marilyn Perez Cabrera
 Kellie Matterson
 Pari Batha & Natalia Meliendrez

Welfare Team Manager**Petrona Kelly**

Multicultural Family Worker
 Multicultural Welfare Workers
 Brighter Futures Workers

Miza Torlakovic
 Juanita Loli, Elena Ferguson, Hayley Bateman & Lydia Manusiu
 Zenaida Edmunds & Desie Erhart

Natural Disasters Resilience Strategy & Community Resilience Engagement Project

Coordinator

Katie Sewell

Tax Help / EAPA

Coordinator

Juanita Loli

Year in review

Funding Partnerships

-  **Department of Social Services**
-  **NSW Department of Family & Community Services, Community Services**
-  **NSW Department of Family & Community Services, Ageing Disability & Home Care**
-  **Samaritans**
-  **ClubsNSW**
-  **The Benevolent Society**
-  **Gosford City Council, Armidale Council, Lake Macquarie City Council**
-  **Multicultural NSW**
-  **NSW Department of Justice**

Our Supporters

We wish to acknowledge and thank all our stakeholders for their continued support of the many and diverse programs delivered throughout the past year.

Networks & Interagencies



Northern Settlement Services supports a range of networks including the Mid North Coast, North Coast & Hunter Rural Multicultural Networks; the Central West, Central Coast, Newcastle & New England Multicultural Interagencies; the Hunter Refugee Network and the Hunter CALD Aged & Disability Services Network.



Chairperson's Report

Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM

The last year has been very successful for NSS in the Hunter as well as Central Coast and satellite offices in Armidale and Tamworth, despite the challenges and changes in funding frameworks affecting our funded programs.

I wish to thank all staff who have contributed so positively to the overall success of the programs.

To our CEO Lulu Tantos a big thank you for her dedication and hard work, especially in working with Settlement Services International (SSI) and 21 other stakeholders in a NSW state wide consortium bid for Settlement Programs. This was successful and funding is secured till 2018. We welcome the Hunter SSI Team who are being hosted by NSS's Hamilton office, to undertake their "Out of Home Care Program" and "Status Resolution Support Services Program".

The major renovations of the Hamilton Office commenced in June this year. Despite staff having to work under difficult circumstances while the renovations of the building took place, the results have certainly been worth it. I want to thank them for their cooperation and patience while carrying out their normal duties.

Most of all I want to thank our Operations Manager Enza Di Stefano not only for overseeing the renovations, but consulting with staff on the design and fit out and therefore creating a more comfortable and enjoyable work environment.

After nearly 15 years of wonderful service to NSS, in the management and delivery of Home Care Packages, we sadly bid farewell to Sue Hristov who has decided to retire. We thank her very much and wish her all the best for the future.

Sue is replaced by Rasa Bajalis and Keiko Clements who will share the management of the organisations Aged Care Programs in the Hunter and Central Coast, and continue to ensure that the needs of our elderly CALD clients continue to be met in the new Consumer Directed Care era. Keiko also undertakes the role of Office Manager at the Central Coast Office. Further I would like to thank our outstanding volunteers in: Homework Centres, Community Visitors Scheme, Welfare as well as Computer Education for the Chinese and Italian seniors.

I thank my fellow **Board Directors** who have given up their time freely. Their contribution on many sub committees, such as the Audit Committee as well as attendance at Governance Training, is much appreciated.

Our Challenges for Next Year are many and diverse: Increase in Refugees; Aged Care Changes; continued upgrading of all NSS amenities etc.

I again wish to thank our dedicated staff and management for their commitment which is evidenced by the many achievements for our respective communities and excellent reputation.

I wish everyone a healthy, successful year ahead.

Trudy Mills – Evers AM
Chair



Chief Executive Officer's Report

Ms Lulu Tantos

It is with pleasure that I present the annual report of Northern Settlement Services for 2014-15.

It has been another busy year for NSS with many significant achievements and challenges as we continue to build on our reputation delivering successful outcomes to newly arrived individuals, families and communities in our regions.

These achievements are highlighted in the various project reports and it would be remiss of me if I didn't thank the senior managers who have gone above and beyond the call of duty to expand our program work, (Alex Burns, Pet Kelly, Sue Hristov, Enza Di Stefano), working cooperatively with government and other organisations, mainstream and migrant, to provide appropriate services to our clients.

Organisations and regions like ours have quite unique networks with a whole host of providers which are linked through various inter-agencies and both formal and informal partnerships optimising client service delivery to the target group.

Across the organisation there are wonderful outcomes in a range of program areas (settlement, aged, welfare, youth, parenting), and our ability and capacity to respond to both altered policy directions and shifting client needs ensures our services remain relevant and transform in line with client expectations.

However, the Community Services Sector as we know it is changing. The sustainability of non-profit social services in the face of tightening funding from government and others, and as private enterprise increasingly looks for profitable opportunities in the social services sector is a concern and a challenge for organisations like ours.

The establishment of strategic partnerships with like-minded organisations to best position organisations for future funding opportunities has become the order of the day.

NSS has had to consolidate its position by forming collaborative partnerships where required to ensure financial viability and service delivery moving forward.

The newly established NSW Settlement Partnership (NSP) is an example of this. Led by Settlement Services International (SSI), the consortium comprises 22 organisations (SSI, the 11 Migrant Resource Centres and multicultural services as well as 10 local and regional organisations based around the state), to deliver settlement services for refugees and migrants in NSW as part of a national three year program – the Settlement Services Program (SSP) administered by the Department of Social Services.

This security allows us to continue to build on past initiatives while focussing on new and emerging issues, of which employment and youth engagement and support are high priorities.

To the fantastic NSS team, I thank you for the achievements of the past year. It would not be possible without your dedication and efforts.

I also offer my sincere thanks to our funding bodies, those that partner and collaborate with us, and those that support us. The generosity of spirit and goodwill of the wider community is also greatly appreciated and we thank all of our supporters and volunteers for sustaining NSS's work with migrants and refugees in promoting diversity in our community.

Finally I would like to acknowledge and thank all members of the board, especially the chairperson and executive, who unwaveringly provided me with support, advice and assistance as and when I required it.

Lulu Tantos
CEO

Settlement Grants Program



Funded by
Department of Social Services



Settlement Support & Communities Team Manager

Alex Burns

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

Introduction

This position provides leadership, assistance, mentoring and resourcing to NSS and other regionally based Settlement Grant Program (SGP) services in their provision of settlement support to highly vulnerable new arrival refugees, families and other permanent visa holders in the Hunter, Central Coast, Northern and Western NSW. It also provides management and support to the Community Builders Project and the Natural Disaster Community Resilience Innovation Program.

2014-2015 saw a changeover of Settlement programs from the management of these by NSS to that as a member of the NSW Settlement Partnership (NSP). This was initially experienced by those projects that made up our Rural Settlement work from March while the program as it covers the Central Coast and Newcastle came under the NSP in July of this year. New reporting procedures also impacted on all settlement staff as we moved away from the OSCAR recording of services delivered to a new "DEX" format based on the Department of Social Services website portal.

In Newcastle the Team manager supported Settlement staff with their work with a new group of refugee families that arrived this year. Many of this group comprised very young families with small children and had been given Refugee status with the primary visa applicants having worked as interpreters in support of the Australian forces. Unlike previous refugee groups the men spoke English well and were well connected to other services upon commencing with our Settlement program. However, the women of the group had limited English and this has made settlement more difficult for them. At the time of exit from the HSS provider several Settlement team members engaged these families and provided case work, access to NSS's playgroups and the NSS parenting group support as well as to the MOMS group for antenatal education and to the NSS' NSW Families Worker, with this worker giving the client a holistic approach to their settlement and parenting issues. Young women from the earlier settlement of non-Defence forces members of this group were also engaged as their needs were for sport, entertainment and other social activities.

Our Rural Team work, and that of the Central Coast, generally have had a different client base as the numbers of Refugees settling in our regional areas are much lower in number than in Newcastle. The issues experienced in the rural areas are dominated by isolation and lack of social support, Domestic and Family Violence as well as problems with access to services due to poor transport.

Fewer mainstream services means that more work is undertaken with capacity building with the existing services and NGOs to help them to better understand settlement work. Work with Refuges, women's support groups, Police, and TAFEs figure high in this aspect of our regional settlement work.

Face to Face work with the various regional and rural SGP Projects in northern and western NSW, during this year is shown in the Table below. Case work with these workers was similar to that of NSS' rural work but also varied. It included a number of matters relating to migration, the impact of various programs on local groups such as employment for woman, especially of Humanitarian African backgrounds in the family day care area and the continued lack of use of Interpreters by services in their dealings with clients of the SGP projects. Some of the support requested included dealing with services that assumed that any migrant and especially those on Temporary Visas should be the work of a settlement worker.

Location	Visits	Location	Visits
Manning Valley	4	Coffs Harbour	3
Lismore	1	Armidale	7
Tamworth	7	Bathurst	4
Dubbo	4	Orange	4
Hunter Outreach	10+		

In all the Team Manager supported 8 Settlement workers outside of Newcastle to address the needs of more than 26 client cases, and a further 5 workers with 21 cases (mainly Afghani and Thai) in the Lower Hunter area of NSS.

Other work relating to the Settlement projects included participating in various meetings to support and promote the work of all NSS Settlement projects, especially at meetings in their regions, or at ones in Sydney. Settlement work continued to be well represented through attendance at the various multicultural Interagencies and networks included across NSS' footprint area.

Representation at six diverse state based network meetings ensured the concerns and issues faced by NSS clientele were heard.

Information sessions

Seven sessions were provided to a wide range of groups including new arrival Afghanis and Congolese in Newcastle, students, educational institutes and service providers. In addition several students gained placement at NSS.

Other Team Work

Other program work included the support and management of our Community Builder's project on the Central Coast, our newly implemented Natural Disasters Resilience Strategy (NDRS) for the CALD community in the Hunter and the Central Coast, our well established "Playing Around The World" program, the establishment of the newly funded Community profile of Inverell project and leadership of the merging of the Central Coast Multicultural Children's Resource Centre with NSS.

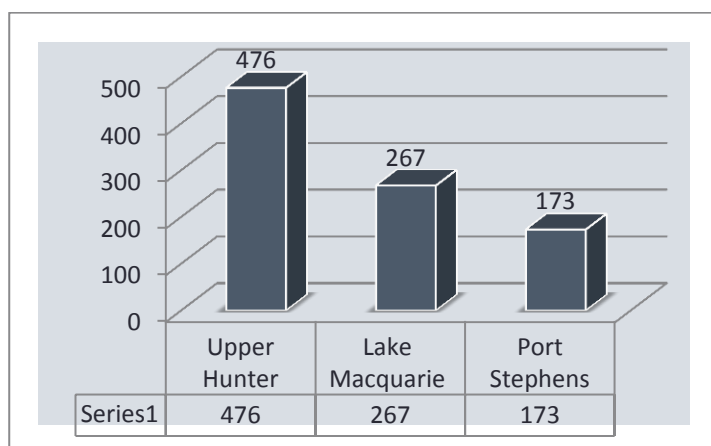


Hunter Welfare Outreach Settlement Grants Program

Rose Oku

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

The Hunter Welfare Outreach SGP project provides support services to newly arrived, vulnerable and disadvantaged refugees and migrants, especially women who are experiencing hardship through isolation, unemployment, domestic violence, homelessness and other misfortunes encountered in their settlement. The SGP outreach work covered 3 service areas in the Hunter this past year.



**SGP Casework Client Contacts
2014-2015**

Service Areas

Upper Hunter: Muswellbrook, Singleton, Cessnock, Aberglasslyn, Maitland and Rutherford

Port Stephens: Raymond Terrace, Karuah, Williamstown, Nelson Bay, Shoal Bay and Lemon Tree Passage

Lake Macquarie: Belmont, Toronto, Charlestown, Redhead, Speers Point, Windale Valentine and Edgeworth

Casework.

Face to face casework was provided to the target group with clients from diverse cultural backgrounds, being several African nations, India, Bangladesh, Nepal, the Philippines, Indonesia, Peru, Thailand, Sri Lanka, Korea, Japan, Pakistan, Fiji, China and more. The Settlement worker works with these clients to ensure their needs are met, by referring them to a wide range of community resources and services, for example, Childcare facilities, Child Protection, Employment, Domestic Violence, Family Mediation, Tenancy Tribunal, Accommodation, Advocacy, Centrelink, TIS, Education and Training services.

During 2014-2015 the project worker has made some 916 Client Contacts. 97% of clients received an average of between 20-40 minutes in consultation, depending upon the complexity and whether the client needed to have an interpreter. Casework is diverse and complex as recently arrived high needs clients, are unsure of how to access services in the community when they require extra support.



Group Work

Multicultural Friendship Groups and playgroups have been developed in different locations throughout the service area at Singleton, Tomaree and Cessnock. There were 42 Information sessions held during 2014-2015 to address, health, isolation, education, volunteering in the community, community capacity building, family relationships, and employment issues. The groups also participate in a range of events organised by the Settlement worker, such as Community Connect Day at Cessnock TAFE, Harmony Day celebrations and the Singleton Multicultural Parenting Program in partnership with Hunter Prelude. Hunter New England Health provided information sessions to the Friendship groups and covered a range of topics to support clients' needs these included; Healthy Eating for families, Depression, Suicide Prevention, Sleeping Problems, Elderly Abuse, Surviving Multiple trauma, Sexually Transmitted Diseases, Foot care and Respiratory issues. Sessions were presented in partnership with other organisations as well: Hunter Prelude, Thowalla Family Centre, Samaritans, Tenancy Advice Service, Singleton Council, Maitland Council and NSW TAFE.

The 3rd Annual Riverlights Festival held in Maitland in October 2014 was a great success with more of the community coming together to celebrate Multicultural Diversity. Similarly, on Saturday 8th November the inaugural Raymond Terrace Multicultural Fiesta was held at the Riverside Park. The communities celebrated indigenous performances, African drumming, markets stalls, traditional crafts, multicultural food, free workshops, and live music. Northern Settlement Services participated in the event by organising an information stall. Refugee Week was celebrated at Tomaree in June which was a success with around 200 people, commemorating historical events for those refugees settling in the Port Stephens area. Other community celebrations were in Lake Macquarie, and in the historical town of Greta in the Hunter Valley.

Singleton Multicultural Parenting Program

The Singleton Multicultural Parenting Program has continued in partnership with Hunter Prelude to hold a parenting program for children with special needs in the community. The group continues to link CALD families to their local community and promote child development. The combined playgroup is held at Singleton Hunter Prelude every 2nd week. Resources were purchased to support the partnership through Singleton Library in April 2015.

Singleton library runs story time and craft with the families and children, this links families into their local community and they learn about the library and how to borrow books (language specific) for children to extend their literacy skills. The group has been involved in developing a parent handbook that incorporates Parenting Program Groups (PPG).

A huge success for the group has been the completion of 4 weeks Triple P Program (TPP) in June by the parents.

Raymond Terrace and surrounds Multicultural Playtime

Harmony Day celebration on 23rd March organised in partnership with First Chance and Thou-Walla family centre was a great success with around 180 people including children attending. This was the group's first year of planning and organising a Harmony Day Celebration a community orientated day where there was great food, and great multicultural activities that children participated in. This playtime group is held every second Monday of the month.

Promotional Activities and Networking

Throughout 2014-15 there were over 42 promotional activities and networking events attended. The SGP presented at TAFE on cultural awareness, social justice and also to share her experience coming from another country to Australia. The project continues as convener of 3 quarterly meetings of the Hunter Rural Multicultural Network, as well as participating in Singleton, Lake Macquarie and Tomaree Interagency Meetings.





New England Settlement Grants Program - Armidale

Judith Roberts

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

The Settlement Grants Program (SGP) provides settlement information, referrals to community agencies, community capacity building, service planning and community development to new arrivals, including migrants, humanitarian entrants, and the dependents of skilled migrants. Humanitarian entrants face multiple barriers to settlement and high levels of socio-economic disadvantage. The client groups most represented are humanitarian entrants who are single parents with large families and single men. Another emerging group are clients who have been granted 866 visas previously having held temporary visas such as a student visa many of whom are from Libya or Iraq. The Armidale SGP also receives requests regularly for access to Migration Advice.

Table 1 Client Statistics

Type	Number
OSCAR 1	25
OSCAR 2	849
OSCAR 3	6,596
OSCAR 4	156

Client Services

Overall client issues identified: family relationships, access to mental health support, Centrelink, employment, housing, transport, debt issues, health access, and homework support, access to childcare and to suitable English classes. The main client group of this service are Humanitarian 202 and 866 visa holders with the next group being migrants on spouse visas. Many young men are also quite a disadvantaged group whose main issues include employment, housing, and access to education and training. Employment opportunities are in industries such as the Tomato Farm, Retail, Aged Care, security work and taxi driving. NSS works with Job Networks and Centrelink to support these clients.

Another area of employment has been childcare which has proven to be a good starting point for employment. Unfortunately there have been some concerns around ways that some organisations have targeted vulnerable new arrival communities where families have sought child care or employment in this field. NSS supports the attendance of our target group at AMEP and LLNP classes at TAFE. Many of our target group have been supported into stable accommodation through private rentals, or through public and community housing. Homes North Community Housing has been very responsive to the housing needs of migrants and refugees in the SGP target group.

There have been many, many excellent outcomes for a number who are students at the University of New England or at the TAFE across a range of disciplines. This year a group of TAFE students completed Health Support, Aged Care and First Aid Certificates which will place them well for employment opportunities. There continues to be a relatively high birth rate among SGP clients. Referral to family support services has been an important resource to support families' needs.

Working with these families has created an opportunity for NSS to continue its collaboration with Hunter New England Health (HNEH) to support clients' health needs.

Child care and access to specialised and general health has been an ongoing need. Some clients have had significant health issues; however, their needs are met well by mainstream health services. Oral health and access to dental services has been identified as an issue requiring support. Clients travelling to Sydney for specialist medical treatment have been supported by SSP in collaboration with HNEH. Clients who have moved onto the Citizenship stage of settlement are extremely proud of their transition from Permanent resident to Citizen of Australia-this year clients from the DRC and Ethiopia have been among the Citizenship recipients. NSS in Armidale and STARTTS have maintained regular contact to support the local Refugee and Refugee like community and through meeting with mainstream services to inform and support these services' work with the Refugee community. NSS has continued to collaborate with the Armidale Women's Shelter and HNEH to facilitate a CALD Women's Support Group. The group has had members from Africa, the Middle East, Poland and Asia. The collaboration among services to support this group has meant information has been provided on a range of topics including Child Safety, Early Intervention Programs for children and a wide range of settlement and health topics. Outreach has been made to Inverell with NSS participation in the Multicultural Festival in March and meetings held with Moree TAFE and Moree Plains Shire Council on outreach visits.

ESL Homework Centre Support

This Homework Support has grown again this year with the numbers of students and volunteers attending. Two days are provided at Drummond School as the location and these are Tuesdays and Wednesdays with Fay Paris as the Coordinator. Like the Centres in Newcastle we have an end of Term Report throughout the year. NSS is auspicing the programs with the support of Department of Education and Communities, Armidale Dumaresq Council, the University of New England and other benevolent organisations. These Centres rely on volunteers from the community and once again NSS' collaboration with the Armidale Referral Volunteer Service has provided a great source of volunteers. The program could not run without the dedication of these volunteers and the leadership of Fay Paris. This year we had our highly valued volunteer Mrs Fran Armitage pass away. NSS nominated her successfully for the Premier's Posthumous Multicultural Honour Roll 2015. Vale Fran. Students who have attended the Home work centre program have improved in their school work and many have gone on to win scholarships at prestigious schools through academic and sporting talent.

Meetings and Committee representation

The SGP is involved in a broad range of networks some of these include the NE Multicultural Interagency Meeting, NE Multicultural Health Access Committee, Armidale Interagency, Domestic Violence Steering Committee and Sanctuary Armidale. NSS Armidale also works closely with the region's Multicultural Health Nurse and in all ways ensures that the health needs of our target group are supported.

Events

These included, Reclaim the Night 2014, Refugee Week and Harmony Day Events in Armidale and Inverell, the Community Relations event in Armidale in late July, Multicultural Festival in Inverell and a Premier's Multicultural Dinner in March.

Summary: Looking back over the year there has been some sadness in our community with Fran's passing and clients experiencing the loss of loved ones overseas. Despite this, it is clear that the community is resilient and looking forward to welcoming new arrivals as they recall their own journeys as new settlers and the inherent need to feel welcomed.



New England Settlement Grants Program - Tamworth

Amalin Sundaravej

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

The Tamworth base of the New England and the Hunter Settlement Rural Service Delivery Program (SGP) provides support services to highly disadvantaged new arrival refugees, family and other permanent resident visa holders who have low English language proficiency. Clients experience hardship through isolation, domestic violence, homelessness, mental health and other issues.

The Tamworth worker is addressing the lack of supportive networks by linking newly arrived migrants to their ethnic groups as well as to the existing *Tamworth International Support Network* (TISN) and now the *Reading Club Plus*. These comprise a supportive network base for new migrants to whom NSS has provided and continues to provide services. In addition, NSS is assisting the refugee and migrant community's development and promoting a sense of self identity, belonging and participation with the broader Tamworth community. It also raises awareness among the mainstream service providers to assist them to become more responsive to needs of the target group in the Tamworth area.

Outreach from the Tamworth office is continuing to identify client groups and to establish contacts/network in Werris Creek and Quirindi as well as in Gunnedah. The Settlement worker approached the public libraries, the Salvos, the churches, the Police Stations and schools in these areas.

Client services included providing assistance with Australian citizenship applications, housing, employment, health matters, pathways to education, family relationship issues, parenting issues, domestic violence, legal issues, overseas skills recognition, migration related issues (e.g., referrals to NSS migration agents); referrals to other mainstream service providers; help with extra English language; access to interpreter service (TIS); help with tax.

In 2015, the *Reading Club Plus* was formed by NSS with an understanding that English literacy is an essential skill for coping with the many demands of life in contemporary Australian society. Tasks ranging from reading the directions on a bottle of medicine, completing a tax return, or accessing information on the Internet, all require a reasonably high level of English literacy. People who are unable to complete such tasks independently are at a considerable disadvantage. While literacy represents only part of an individual's overall skills and abilities, the growing share of skilled and knowledge-based jobs in the economy has increased the importance of good literacy skills and especially for non-English speakers.

Referrals were made to: DIBP (website, 131-881), NSS Migration Agents, Jobs Australia (including liaison with caseworkers), Skilled Employment, Processing factory, private lamb abattoir, private beef abattoirs; Red Lea Chickens (egg picking/packing), Tamworth Community Centre (Volunteer Program), Medicare, Law Access, Legal Aid, Chandler & MacLeod Employment, Tamworth Regional Council, State MP Kevin Anderson; TAFE.

Employment opportunities

In Tamworth, employment opportunities for our new migrants and refugees target group, both skilled and semi-skilled, continue to find employment in the abattoirs (i.e., lamb and beef) and chicken agro processing plants which are the major sources of employment. Some find work in the beef abattoir in Inverell and recently, at the Gunnedah leather tanning factory. Various reasons hinder their employment such as overseas skills not being recognized in Australia and that the skills assessment process itself is quite expensive and lengthy. Other factors include the absence of local work experience, fluency in English language communication, understanding Australian work culture. The meatworks continue to attract mostly male Africans to Tamworth and now includes Burmese (Karens) people from refugee background.

Recent newcomers and job seekers are the Rohingyas, Iranians and Iraqis. In 2015, several



Fiesta La Peel: Amalin at the NSS marquee

workers mostly from the Philippines working for a lamb abattoir have recently been granted Australian permanent residency status and have since brought their families to Tamworth. Main health complaint heard is the repetitive injury caused by hard and routine work at the abattoirs. Smoking is also very much evident to "combat the cold" workplace as heard from many abattoir workers.

Other migrant communities, especially Filipino women continue to be employed in chicken hatchery plants, egg picking and packing. A few younger women have gone on to obtain TAFE certificates in age care and community health care which seem to be the preferred field at present.

Women migrants continue to suffer isolation as they do not know how to drive a car. Sometimes, this leads to their not being able to attend AMEP classes in Tamworth (AMEP is not offered in smaller towns). Incidences of domestic violence have been experienced by some of these women as well as depression and anxiety verging on mental illness. Unfortunately, a lot of these incidents are unreported because of 'shame' and 'stigma' attached to these issues in their communities. Some of what is reported as a 'DV' issue is often also due to misunderstanding and miscommunication between two people coming from different cultures. These women continue to suffer in a 'culture of silence'.

New Clients and Countries of Origin

Clients	Number	Clients	Number
Sudan	4	Myanmar	5
Philippines	18	UK	1
Malaysia	2	Sri Lanka	1
India	3	Italy	2
Iraq	1	Kenya	1
China	2	Zimbabwe	1
Bangladesh	1	Mexico	2
South Africa	1	Somalia	1
Korea	1	Indonesia	1
		TOTAL	48

Refugee Settlement Grants Project Service

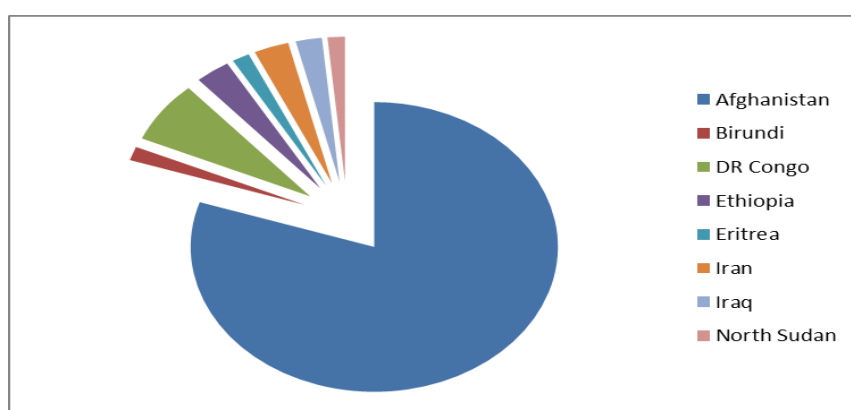
Lydia Manusiu, Hayley Bateman and Marie Zawadi

Funded by
Department of Social Services



The Settlement Grants refugee work aims to increase independence, knowledge, and ability for humanitarian entrants and new arrivals, to navigate and access mainstream services and promote self-reliance in the Newcastle SSD. Eligible clients who have resided in Australia for less than 5 years are supported in their settlement by casework, information and referrals, advocacy, information sessions, promotion, settlement support groups, networking and mentoring.

Service users come from Afghanistan, Burundi, Democratic Republic of Congo, Ethiopia, Eritrea, Iran, Iraq, and South Sudan. Afghani clients make up 85% of SGP users.



CASEWORK/REFERRALS/GROUPS: Through the period of July 2014 to June 2015 there have been **350** clients registered under the program. There have also been **1619** instances of casework and **3830** referrals (internally and externally).

Isolation is a main concern with service users. In assisting clients to minimise this impact, several families have been referred to NSS playgroups, parenting groups and STARTTS swimming group. Home visitations have also increased, to cater for women who may have young children and are unable to drive and/or have difficulties in accessing the main office. With some families the issue of isolation has led to family violence. Access to these families is difficult as the victims have little or no English skills while the primary visa holders are often able to access services freely as they speak English. Other issues saw group outcomes with several Congolese clients being linked to migration assistance while 11 were supported to gain Australian Citizenship.

Employment prospects can become a problem particularly with the many single men in the most recent arrival client group entering the settlement program. There is often great pressure on them to provide for their families overseas and many are living in shared accommodation with students/single men as a way of handling the high cost of living. Most of these men entered casual employment. As a contrast some who arrived a year earlier have been able to access TAFE to undertake training with 18 of these Clients completing the Aged Care Certificate 3 course, a Disability course and a Food Safety Supervisor Certificate. This period has similarly seen an increase of families relocating to Sydney, Melbourne and Brisbane. Main reason for their resettlement is the lack of employment opportunities in the Newcastle SSD and unaffordable housing options.

INFORMATION SESSIONS:

- A DVD by the NSW Department of Fair Trading "renting a home: a tenants' guide to rights and responsibilities" to 12 members of Afghan background.
- Tenancy training and with different Real Estate Agents around property maintenance for the Congolese and Burundi Communities.
- Mental Health and Families NSW held an information session on "Wellness: physical and psychological health – how to look after yourself" for Afghani women. 11 women and 15 children attended.
- Information session with the Smith Family Saver plus Program held for members of the Congolese community.
- information sessions held for the Congolese Women's and Children's Group.
- Mental Health Team's information session with 11 Congolese and Burundi clients attending.
- Two presentations given at TAFE NSW for students of Community Services Classes.



"Wellness: Physical and Psychological Health – how to look after yourself" Information Session

EVENTS/NETWORKING/MEETINGS/EXPO - HIGHLIGHTS:

The Refugee Settlement workers have been involved in the many Events supporting and enabling clients to participate in:

- Harmony Day at Lake Macquarie, Refugee Week Picnic Activities Day, Refugee Week Movie Night, and Hamilton Multicultural Carnivale, Multicultural Expo at the MNC, the Riverlights Multicultural Festival held at Maitland, Multicultural Day at the ECC Waratah and Insight Family Fun Day.
- A Multicultural day at Waratah Technology Campus where members of the Congolese Community Women's Group attended and were able to sell some of their food and gave a Community Kitchen Cooking Demonstration.
- Participated in the Cultural Exchange road trip to Port Macquarie and Taree.
- Assisted and supported the Congolese community monthly meetings
- Helped establish the South Sudanese Community's Sudanese Women's group.

Other highlights have been: "Is Bilingualism causing a delay" forum at Lambton Bowling Club, STARTTS Swimming Group at Balance Gym in Mayfield, Riverlights Multicultural Festival in Maitland Multicultural Health Consultation at ECC, Vote of solidarity at MNC, Hamilton Multicultural Carnivale, International Women's Day at Hunter Women's Centre, Disengaged Youth Training in Sydney DSS, Newcastle City Council Multicultural plan Consultation at JNC, Diversity Day, STARTTS youth training, DSS SGP conference, Refugee Week Picnic Activities Day, Refugee Week Movie Night, Cooks Hill Refugee Beach Safety Program, Youth Health Forum, surviving multiple trauma at JHH, Multicultural Christmas Carols, Community development in refugee communities training in Sydney DSS, HNE Health Consultation at NSS. White Ribbon International Day for elimination of violence against women.



Refugee Week Picnic Day at Jesmond Park



Multicultural Youth Project

Tonkoh Kamara

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

The objective of the Settlement Youth Project is to identify issues and then design, deliver programs and projects that can address issues faced by new arrival young people from CALD background aged 12 to 25 years as part of their settlement within the Newcastle LGA, with outreach to Maitland, Lake Macquarie and Central Coast as necessary. The project aims to increase young peoples' engagement and participation in programs and projects which will lead to increase in accessing services, foster social integration and to develop their responses in filling in gaps in youth services provision, especially to new, small and emerging communities.

The Multicultural Youth project worker's main role is the provision of support through information dissemination and referrals to specialist service providers, casework, advocacy and mentoring. It also plans, develops and delivers capacity building programs through the engagement and participation of CALD young people in socially inclusive educational and community programs. This involves the project worker in local and regional youth events, forums, conferences and community networks.

The youth project engaged 94 CALD young people this year in casework, dissemination information and referred 429 young people to other services over issues that included dealing with credit and finance agencies, correctional services, schools and other education providers, homework support centres, CALD youth homelessness and accommodation issues, employment search support, the department of human services, charity organizations and dealing with Sporting clubs and other support with social participation.

The project has outreached to schools with large numbers of young people from CALD background in most schools around Newcastle and the Hunter. The worker does One-on-one mentoring in those schools and group mentoring programs called CALD Youth Life Skills issues addressed during the mentoring sessions include; Team work, leadership skills, discipline, law and order, time management skills, the use of public spaces by youth, rights and responsibilities, racism, bullying and cultural diversity in Australia.

Promoted

The youth project was promoted in the NSS homework centres, at the NSW youth collective, Youth Action NSW, the Talking tactics project, youth and combined youth interagency meetings, Regional Youth Development Officers Network conference (RYDON), Schools and Services expos, Newcastle City Council, and Harmony Day activities.



*Cultural Jam trip to Blackbutt Reserve
October 2014*

The youth project worker has developed and supported the delivery of a range of sporting, recreational and community activities for CALD youth such as; The multicultural youth soccer team (Hunter Simba FC), Culture jam in support of the MNC, the school based drama project partly funded by the NSS at San Clemente Catholic High school and the holiday indoor soccer matches, all a great method of encouraging CALD youth participation to increase their social integration into the Australian way of life.

The youth project in trying to increase the chances of youth employability, works in partnership with recruitment, employment training organizations and job network service providers which has led to 26 CALD young people gaining employment through the youth worker's assistance.

The table shows the number of young people that the project has worked with from CALD background as a percentage around Newcastle and Hunter Regions. Young people from South Sudan were the largest group with 40% and Sierra Leone being the lowest at 1%. "Others" comprise countries such as: Iraq, Tanzania, Nigeria, Pacific Island, Philippine, South Korea, Ghana.

Country	Percentage
Sudanese	40%
Congolese	36%
Liberian	4%
Afghanis	4%
Mauritanian	3%
Burundi & Rwanda	3%
Ethiopian	2%
Sierra Leone	1%
Others	7%

In conclusion, the project has been able to help with the development of strategies to support CALD youth engagement and participation in Newcastle LGA and the Hunter region, in partnership and collectively through youth networks such as; Youth Action NSW, NSW Youth collective and the Multicultural Youth Network (MYAN). The project has encouraged CALD youth to improve their self-esteem and confidence in accessing services for their benefit and has supported young CALD people in a range of socio-cultural activities focused on social integration into the Australian way of life.



Volunteer Coordination Program

Michael Freund - Educational Programs

Cassitie Galliot - Welfare Programs

Funded by

Department of Social Services and ClubsNSW



Volunteer Co-ordination Overview:

The purpose of these positions is to co-ordinate assistance for NSS refugee & migrant SGP clients, from people in the wider Newcastle community, through a range of Educational and Welfare volunteering programs. Our work is generated by individual requests for volunteer assistance received from clients or staff, and by the requirements of our managed programs. This focus drives the process of promotion, recruitment, and registration of suitable volunteers to fill those requests and program requirements. Volunteering vacancies are promoted on the NSS Volunteers webpage and email list, and via University of Newcastle services: iLEAD, Teach Outreach, Careers Service. Ongoing guidance & support is provided to all volunteers, and training workshops are organised.

During 2014-2015 various events were attended, including: SGP Rural Conference at DSS Sydney; Hunter Refugee Network and Newcastle Multicultural Interagency Meetings; Harmony Day and Refugee Week various events; Volunteering Expo at University of Newcastle; RYDON Youth Conference; Presentations to TAFE classes; NSW Centre for Volunteering: A Community Conversation; Multicultural Expo at MNC; and more.

Volunteer Activity Statistics for 2014-15

Volunteer Category	Educational Volunteers	Welfare Volunteers
Enquiries Received*	approx. 130	approx. 100
Registered	67	23
Re-started or Extended	27	11
Placed in Program	94	32
Inactive or Withdrew	65	6

The table shows volunteer activity for the reporting period. As at 30 June 2015, approximately 95 registered volunteers were actively working in our volunteering programs (see next few pages).

**Note that many more volunteering enquiries were received than were actually needed by clients/programs.*

Recognition of NSS Volunteers:

NSS sincerely thanks all of our wonderful volunteers for 2014-2015. They are the life-blood of our Educational and Welfare programs which provide much needed support for many recently-arrived client families. Their contributions were recognised this year by: a morning tea & certificate presentation held at NSS during National Volunteer Week, an end-of-year dinner at the Premier Hotel, and a luncheon in Gregson Park.

Special congratulations go to two NSS volunteers who won **Regional Volunteer Awards** at a ceremony organised by the Hunter Volunteer Centre (HVC) and the NSW Centre for Volunteering, held in October:

Brittany Palmer - HVC Young Volunteer of the Year 2014

Maree Thorpe - HVC Senior Volunteer of the Year 2014



EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMS

Homework Centres (HWC): Around 90 volunteers participated in the extremely successfully HWC program throughout the 2014-2015 reporting period.

A major milestone was achieved with 2015 marking our 10th continuous year of providing this valuable service to refugee & migrant children. This large project was managed by Michael and staffed by a dedicated team of Co-ordinators: Cassitie Galliot, Josephine O'Hara, David Conway, Stephanie Couch, Bridie Scott, and Jordan McDougall.

Over 2014-2015, our HWCs at partner schools **Waratah Technology Campus** and **San Clemente High School** continued strongly, while changes to other schools were necessary to better support our newest arrival clients, namely, Afghan refugee families:

- After 5 successful years at St. Pius X High School (2009-2014) our HWC was brought to a close. A new HWC was started at **Jesmond Primary School** in Term 3, 2014, and has become very well established, supporting 15 children (see photo).



- In December we also said farewell to Hamilton Primary School (2006-2014) with a special celebration for children, parents, volunteers, and teachers, to mark the end of a wonderful 9 year partnership. In Term 1, 2015, our new HWC commenced at **Islington Primary School**. In its first 6 months this HWC has performed even better than expected, assisting 20 children.



Islington Primary School HWC

The HWC program received 60 student referrals from ESL teachers in 2014 (Terms 3 & 4), and 66 referrals in 2015 (Terms 1 & 2). Average weekly attendances were: 46 students and 44 volunteers. The majority of students were refugees from Afghanistan, Democratic Republic of Congo, South Sudan, and Ethiopia, plus a few students of Vietnamese migrant background.

All students received weekly one-to-one or small group volunteer support with English literacy, reading practice, homework, assignments, etc. We recognised the hard work of students with 'Student of the Term' awards, and also held fun, social events such as End of Term educational games and Harmony Day celebrations. Parental participation was actively encouraged through HWC registration days, and by invitations to these social events.

In-Home & In-School Tutoring: 10 volunteers participated

NSS volunteers provided weekly support for students, with English literacy, reading practice, homework, etc. in the client home, at a public library, or in the school classroom.

WELFARE PROGRAMS

As the new coordinator overseeing the Welfare Programs from October, the end of 2014 was spent assessing active volunteers and clients and updating all related documents. Once complete, the coordinator was able to register new volunteers and clients into the programs. In regard to client groups accessing the Welfare Programs, there has been a major shift in keeping with the new arrival groups accessing the NSS Settlement services. Over 50% of clients were of Afghani background (including many Hazara), while the remainder came from various backgrounds in the Asian and African regions. A total of 35 clients received assistance from volunteers in the welfare programs during this period.

Adult Literacy:

16 volunteers assisted 24 clients to improve their English literacy by visiting the clients on a weekly basis in their homes.

Citizenship Assistance:

3 clients were assisted individually to practice and prepare for the citizenship test. Volunteers helped clients progress through the citizenship booklet to learn all the information for the test.



Driving Supervision:

10 volunteers supervised 8 clients while on their Learner's licence, helping them improve their driving skills and get their hours up in preparation for their "P" Provisional licence test. 3 of these clients were successful in gaining their provisional licence thanks to this support during this period, with many more success stories expected soon.

Companionship/Social support:

3 clients were supported by 3 volunteers with social support. Volunteers visit clients in their homes or meet with them at a local park or café for a regular catch-up.

All of these volunteer activities assist our clients to become more independent and allow them to participate more widely in society. The flow-on effects include greater job prospects, less social isolation, and the ability to access more services.

Other programs, events and donation drives:

3 volunteers assisted with various NSS playgroups throughout the year and 8 volunteers assisted with one-off events, including the Multicultural Expo, Refugee Week picnic, and a National Families Week fun day. Many of our volunteers have also kindly donated items for a number of donation drives organised as part of the Welfare Programs.

Volunteer Training:

In March, all our SGP volunteers were invited to attend an ESL workshop organised by the Welfare Coordinator. A volunteer with ESL qualifications ran the workshop at NSS. 18 Volunteers participated and due to their positive feedback, the workshop will be held again next year.





Settlement Grants Program - Central Coast

Nellie Srisurapon

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

This service provides assistance and information through casework, referrals, advocacy and group work to migrant and humanitarian new arrivals, including youth, and their communities throughout the Central Coast. This program, which works out of our Central Coast office in Bateau Bay, is available to eligible visa holders who have settled in Australia for 5 years or less. The Central Coast consists of small pockets of communities along the coast and also in the hinterland. There are also many small communities that are isolated and have no access to public transport. This is a large service area covering nearly 1,900sq. km so the program provides outreach appointments at safe, convenient locations across the region. Settlement on the Central Coast, in this program's target group is predominately by those holding a family stream visa.

Casework and Advocacy:

The casework in this region for the last 12 months has been consistent. The main casework issue has, yet again, been associated with Family and Domestic Violence (FDV). Community members experiencing FDV also require casework around their legal rights, lack of income, housing and especially communication. We readily access the Translating and Interpreter Service (TIS) to ensure all clients understand the information given to them, including our role and the referral process and we also advocate for the use of accredited Interpreters. Other issues were around education, employment, income support, migration, citizenship, isolation, health and transport.

Mental well-being has been an issue on the rise of late and more of the target group are in need of counselling, especially within the legal system and medical practitioners. Support and advocacy was also required in relation to crisis accommodation, income and material support and the referral pathways. Challenges of insufficient refuge accommodation for women, particularly single women, is an ongoing issue.



Interpreter Workshop



Multicultural Expo 2014

This project has also been very involved with the CALD DV committee to develop a DVD resource raising awareness of FDV is finally becoming a reality, with the development of a DVD on FDV for CALD on the Central Coast and this will be launched In February 2016.

Case work there were:-

- 21 instances of use of the Translating and Interpreter Service.
- 7 Information sessions for woman were held for the target group on Women's Health, Employment Law, Well Being and Family Law. 53 participants
- 11 instances of cross cultural information provided to local service providers on request when servicing their clients of a CALD background.
- Assisted in organizing 2 Community workshops on the Access and Use of Interpreters

Referrals:

The Program has seen increased referrals from both district hospitals, coming from the social workers or the maternity midwives. Issues presenting are mainly around isolation and/or FDV. Referrals are also from Family Support Services, including FRS, TAFE teachers and the community themselves.

Referrals have also been made to local ethnic groups for support to overcome issues of isolation. Referrals were made to 44 local services (main referral pathway is to Centrelink, Legal Aid, counseling services and refuges) and 11 clients were referred to NSS volunteering programs and 15 to migration appointments.

Regular emails were sent to over 90 community members with information on education and training, activities and events, health issues, parenting/children, among many other topics. 783 formal and informal referrals made electronically for members of the target group with 2,900 instances of contact made electronically.

Networking and Promotion:

- 7 Central Coast Multicultural Interagency meetings were held throughout the year. The worker managed all correspondence in regards to the as well as organizing guest speakers for the bi monthly meetings.
- Assisted in organizing the Central Coast Multicultural Expo 2014 with CCMI members. Over 70 Services attended with over 500 participants. Theme for 2014 - Essential Emergency Services and Life Skills
- 5 Agency visits - TAFE C.S. Students, Gosford Hosp. midwives, Biala Sexual Health, TAFE Youth Services Students, Evolution Youth Services.
- Conducted Cultural Competency training workshop for 9 participants
- "16 Days of Activism" – White Ribbon Walk/Breakfast/ Promotion Stalls
- Promoted NSS at 11 TAFE AMEP classes in Wyong and Gosford
- Presented at NSW RAC meeting on CALD challenges and gaps re FDV on the Central Coast
- Attended 10 Domestic Violence CALD meetings
- Presented the CALD Domestic Violence DVD at the 2015 Rural Conference at DSS Head Office, Sydney
- Supported Community Groups at 5 Lands Walk event
- Promoted AFL Multicultural game to 3 High Schools
- Promoted NSS services at The Chinese Cultural Festival and Harmony Day 2014
- Attended Refugee Week celebration at Green Pont Com. Centre

Events NSS has participated in during the year.



Russian Group



Asian Cup 2015



CVS Volunteer Week



Signing of Declaration stating Newcastle as a Refugee Welcome Zone



NSS Volunteer Week



You Kidding Me Expo



Refugee Week

Aged Care Services



Funded
by
Department of Social Services and
NSW Family & Community Services, Ageing
Disability & Home Care



Home Care Packages (HCP)

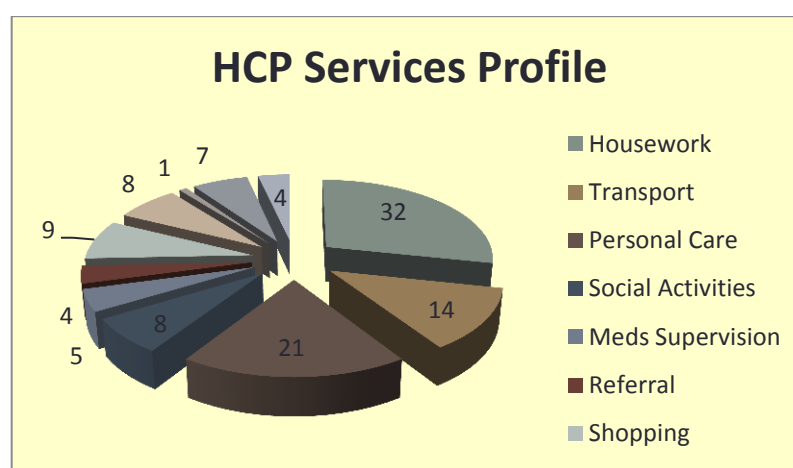
Sue Hristov, Lupe Fonua & Tima 'Oto

Funded by
Department of Social Services

The Home Care Packages program is in its 15th year of successful operation and continues to support older people to remain living in their own home as independently as possible for as long as possible. Our target group is older people from Culturally and Linguistically Diverse Backgrounds (CALD) in the Hunter region. We are currently funded to provide Level 2 low care assistance to 42 people across the Hunter.

CARE RECIPIENT PROFILE - care recipients come from 14 different cultural backgrounds:

Italian 44%	Greek 13.8%	Polish 11%	Chinese 8.3%
Dutch 5.5%	Macedonian 5.5%	Ukrainian 5.5%	Vietnamese 2.7%
German 2.7%	Hungarian 2.7%	Slovenian 2.7%	Filipino 2.7%
Chilean 2.7%			



Of the total of 36 out of 42 packages full at 30th June:

- 28 were female
- 8 Male
- Aged from 65 to 94 years old
- 6 having a diagnosis of dementia
- 25 living alone
- 11 having a live-in carer

TURNOVER AND OCCUPANCY RATES

The program has experienced a higher than usual turnover rate (more than double the number in the previous year)- 23 clients exited packages compared to 11 last year - 14 moved to residential facilities, 6 passed away and 1 moved to another provider due to higher care needs, and 2 exited for other reasons.

One of those reasons was due to the introduction of income tested fees from 1st July 2014- one client exited the package and made other support arrangements due to the significant level of income tested fees she would be required to pay.

The introduction of income tested fees, in addition to the existing basic fee, also seems to be a contributing factor in the lower number of people willing to take up a package – therefore packages are more difficult to fill and remain vacant for longer despite the concerted efforts of Coordinators. The occupancy rate at the end of June was 88% (with 36 out of 42 packages full) compared to 96.60% the previous year. Sector feedback indicates other providers are experiencing similar problems filling Level 2 packages.

LEVEL OF SERVICE PROVISION – We provided 107 hours of direct assistance per week (down from 123 hours the previous year) mainly due to a number of higher care clients exiting packages. 86.5% of our clients received 4 hrs or less assistance/wk- and 13.5. % received 5hrs or more due to complex care needs.

MODEL OF SERVICE PROVISION – we continue to use the Brokerage Model for direct services as it has proven to be the most effective/efficient way of meeting the linguistic and cultural needs of our client group. The overall responsibility for Program Management/ Service Coordination rests with 3 Coordinators (2 from February 2015), who also manage on call 24 hours a day seven days a week. The direct service provision -care workers who go to people's homes- is contracted from 5 reputable agencies.

CHALLENGES: The Conversion of Packages to Consumer Directed care (CDC) – up skilling the organization and staff for the implementation of CDC's by July 2015 has been, and continues to be, a major focus and a major challenge. On the whole, the reaction to the changes under CDC was quite positive- and all care recipients, except one- were happy to sign new agreements. The flexibility and the availability of new options that can now be paid for out of the package (e.g. personal alarms, mobility aids/equipment, hydrotherapy classes etc.) and the option of using hire cars, cleaning companies – were good selling points and were well received by care recipients. As were the new individual budgets, once people were assisted to understand them, which allowed people to see the income and costs involved in delivering their services in a very transparent way. Especially welcomed was the fact that any unused money rolls over month by month for them to use on additional services in the future or to pay for larger items or longer term goals. Two care recipients chose some degree of self-management.

FUTURE CHALLENGES

- Income tested fees, in addition to basic fees, will likely to continue to be a challenge in filling packages- resulting in lower occupancy rates which have implications for ongoing financial viability.
- An effective marketing strategy needs to be developed in order for NSS to remain competitive in attracting new care recipients in an increasingly market driven environment.
- Automating, as much as possible, all aspects of managing CDC's, needs to be a priority for the organization, in order to maximize efficient & effective use of Coordinators /Financial Management Staff time- and this in turn will help maximize the value for money passed onto care recipients.

On a personal note, as I will be leaving NSS at the end of September I would like to thank NSS for the opportunity to work in a job that I loved with my whole heart and soul over the past 14 years. The people I have worked with, particularly my fellow Coordinators Tima and Lupe, the friendships that have been made over the years and the wonderful clients I have had the privilege of assisting and hopefully in some way contributing to their wellbeing- all have made an indelible imprint on my heart and I will miss all of you immensely. I wish the organization and everyone associated with it all the best for the future.

Sue (Slavica) Hristov - HCP Coordinator –Aged Services Manager



Multicultural Access Project Hunter (MAP)

Rasa Bajalis

**Funded by the Department of Social Services and NSW
Department of Family and Community Services, Ageing,
Disability and Home Care**

The role of the regional MAP is to facilitate access of culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) communities to Home and Community Home Care Program (HCCP) and related services and programs. Provide input into service development and planning and support services to develop culturally competent practises.

It has been a year of change and challenges for both the aged and the disability sectors.

During 2014-2015 there was much conversation and community consultations re changes with disability and the continuing launch of NDIS in the Newcastle region. As the Hunter MAP, I participated in the Disability Advisory Council Roundtable conversations and the Ability Links Advisory Committee. The most significant contribution was the establishment of the CALD Disability Engagement Group. This was collaboration with MDAA and eventually other stakeholders to provide a forum to strengthen capacity of relevant services to engage with communities from CALD backgrounds living with disability, raise awareness amongst these CALD communities in Newcastle and Hunter region, and to encourage collaboration between CALD communities living with disability and relevant services. The outcome of a community consultation was a submission for funding to employ a project coordinator to develop a CALD community advisory project to educate and promote changes in disability service system and build CALD community awareness of disability. This model was presented by myself and John Biswas at the "Cultural Competence in Disability Conference".

Participated with Home and Community Care Development Officers (HACC DO's), Central Coast MAP and the HACC Training team to facilitate the HACC Regional Forum: "Resilient Workplaces - Caring for the People Who Care" on 5th and 20th Nov. Both workshops well attended, with 47 on 5th and 65 on 20th. The feedback was extremely positive.

Delivered with Central Coast MAP two Cross Cultural Awareness (Organisational Perspectives) training courses in March and May 2015. Worked collaboratively with the MAP network to produce index of MAP projects and resources in metropolitan and relevant regional areas.

The Broadband for Seniors computer classes have evolved into "Tech Savvy for Seniors" during this past year. Monday's group continues to be Chinese ethno-specific with our long term faithful volunteer Samson teaching his community. Tuesday's group has grown and now has 2 volunteers supporting the multicultural group. Both groups have favoured IPADS and lap tops and the sessions are full of the sounds of downloaded music and stories of skyping their families in their native countries. They constantly endorse the joy of this new found knowledge of the world of the internet!

In collaboration with Alzheimer's Australia and members of the Hunter New England Health Multicultural Health unit, NSS supported CALD Open Days at the Memory Loss Centre in Percy St Hamilton. The aim was to have a program of ethno-specific groups visiting the Memory Centre during Dementia Awareness Month in September 2014. An informal session on Memory Loss was presented by Michelle Bruce- Basic (the CALD Liaison and Resource Development Officer from Alzheimer's Australia). The presentation was on "Staying Connected", resource kits provided to the participants, included dementia information and resources in English and in translated relevant languages. The use of professional interpreters ensured that language was not a barrier to understanding the information provided. Three sessions were held over two days and each was well attended. Communities represented at these sessions were from Chinese, Vietnamese, Italian, Macedonian, Polish, Hungarian and Russian.

The feedback was so positive that this continued into a "Memory Loss Road Show" in 2015. Sessions were held in Taree, Muswellbrook, Singleton, Central Coast and another visit to Newcastle over a two month period.

Challenges:

1st July 2015 sees the commencement of the transition of the existing Home and Community Care program to the Commonwealth Home Support Programme (CHSP).

An emerging challenge is the need for additional work to explain some of the concepts for consumer direction and individual empowerment where language definitions and equivalent terms do not exist. We also need to address topics such as 'user pay' and the reasons for increasing emphasis on consumer fees and contributions. The focus of all projects is the support to the communities.



Hunter Multicultural Respite Service

Tima 'Oto & Dominique Nyilas

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**



Hunter Multicultural Respite Service (HMRS) provides respite care for frail older people and people with dementia from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds who have difficulties accessing or maintaining participation in Day Care Centre activities.

The philosophy of the respite service is to provide a caring, high quality support that recognises and respects the rights, needs and dignity of each individual. Clients enjoy an atmosphere of acceptance and caring for their safety as well as their well-being. The family and other primary carers are also supported and receive respite in their role. The respite service is provided in a way that is appropriate for the client both culturally as well as linguistically.

Model of Service Provision

HMRS is staffed by a part time coordinator and direct care services are provided on a brokerage model, i.e. care workers are contracted from a number of local service providers. The brokerage model has proven to be an efficient and effective way as it enables the project to access a wider pool of workers and enables the service to better meet the cultural and linguistic needs of particular clients.

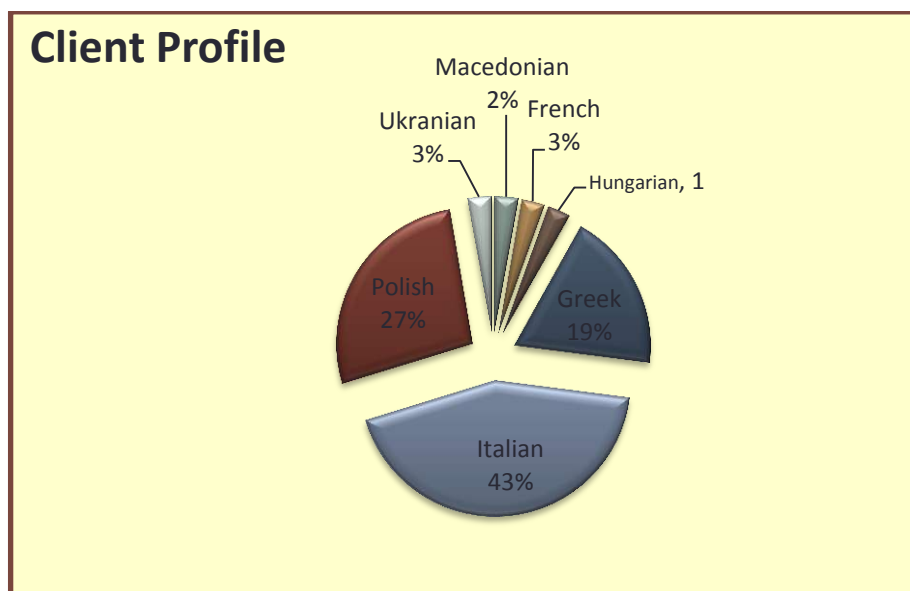
Service provided

Between 01 July 2014 and 30 June 2015 a total of 29 clients received weekly services between 2 and 8 hours per week including transport assistance for one client. 10 clients attend 2 days every week; 4 new clients started receiving the service since last reporting; 7 exited the service due to entering permanent residential care facilities; others no longer needing respite and a few passed away. Clients are formally assessed and regularly reviewed with client referred to the service offered support within a short time or placed on waiting list. The majority of the clients live in Newcastle and Lake Macquarie LGA's, but there are some who reside in Port Stephens, Upper Hunter and Maitland areas. 16 % male and 84% female. The age ranges between 70 and 100 years of age, the average age being 85 years – of this 84% female and 16% male.

Table 1: Day Care Centres, Health and Wellness Centre and Clients as at 30/06/2015	
Allawah Day Centre, Wallsend	1
Cardiff Seniors Multicultural Health and Wellness Centre	2
Greek Seniors Health and Wellness Centre	5
Greek Holy Apostles Health and Wellness Centre	6
Italian Seniors Health and Wellness Centre	5
Maitland Multicultural Friendship Group	2
Polish Seniors Multicultural Health and Wellness Centre	6
Wattlegrove Day Care Centre	2
Total	29 clients

Table 2: Client Characteristics at the Day Centre

Gender		Age range					Client condition	
Male	Female	55_65	66-75	76-85	86-90	91+	Dementia	Frail
4	21	0	3	9	10	3	4	21



Multicultural Dementia and Disability Carer Support Group

The project coordinates the monthly meetings of the support group of 13 members. The age ranges between 62 and 88 years.

The group is well established and several carers have a long history of friendship and developed a strong bonding over the years. The members are encouraged to share their burden with each other in a warm and understanding atmosphere.

This group is invaluable for new carers who are struggling with their caring role physically, emotionally, psychologically as well as needing relevant education, information in order to cope. Guest speakers from a wide variety of professions are invited to talk about topics important to the group, for instance; Memory Loss - Dementia, Depression and Anxiety, Stress Management, Healthy Eating, Rights and Responsibilities - Elder Abuse, End of Life Decisions and Heart Disease and prevention.



Hunter Multicultural Social Support Service

Tima 'Oto

Funded by

Department of Social Services and NSW Department of Family and Community Services, Ageing, Disability and Home Care

The MSSS program was extended to Lower Hunter to address the needs of CALD groups in the area. It commenced in October 2014, with the Vietnamese Social Group. After consultations with several CALD groups in this area such as the Samoan community, the Dutch/German, Maori and New Zealand, Tongan, Filipino, and Spanish Speaking communities; the Filipino and the Spanish Speaking communities have joined the program and are now meeting monthly.

The philosophy of the Multicultural Social Support Service Project is to support CALD HACC target groups to socialize in a safe and friendly environment. Three groups were supported with a variety of information sessions. Topics covered were Women's health related issues, cancer awareness, breast cancer, eye problems, stroke, and foot care. There was an information session on how to use interpreters in hospitals and elsewhere and how to ask the right questions of your GP. Centrelink presented information about the Portable Aged Pension. We also celebrated National Days such as the Filipino Independence Day, the Vietnamese New Year in February and many more.

The program provided about 12 hours monthly of socializing activities to these groups. Meanwhile referrals to My Aged Care to register these clients for further services is slowly progressing through the system

Vietnamese Group consists of about 15 people. Their monthly get together is always well attended as for some members this program is their only social outlet. The program this year featured speakers from Hunter New England Health provided by Carmen Vecchi, the Multicultural Health Liaison Officer from the Multicultural Health Unit. Eye problems, foot care, hospital experience, stroke and advanced care planning were covered. An interpreter is present to assist with these information sessions. Lunch outings are always popular and the highlight of the year for the Vietnamese group is the trip to Cabramatta which occurs in November annually.



Filipino Group consists of 16 people – All attend monthly meetings and their program for the year consists of celebrating their Independence Day, Filipino Fiesta, and Mother's Day Lunch. Information sessions on heart health, stroke, the right question to ask your Doctor and Centrelink updates. We have 8 volunteers registered to assist in the group.



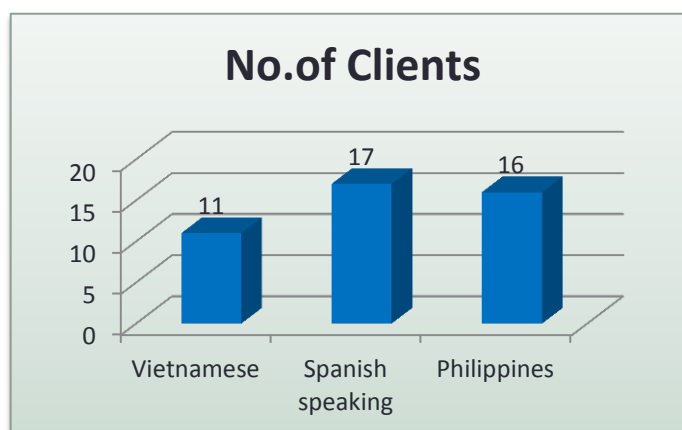
Spanish Group consists of 17 people attending monthly – this group started in April and is still growing. 3 sessions so far have had speakers from the Hunter New England Health to provide information on Cancer Awareness, Stroke and Eye Health.

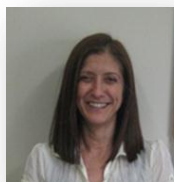
During the early stages of the project we have recruited volunteers to assist with group activities such as setting up the room for meetings and general activities.



The majority of the clients about 73% reside in Newcastle, 25% in Lake Macquarie and 2% in Kurri Kurri LGA's.

Moving forward plans are for all the volunteers to access training in order that they feel supported in the important role of assisting in maintaining the quality of service for the groups participants.





Central Coast Multicultural Social Support Service

Kellie Matterson, Natlia Meliendrez and Marilyn Perez Cabrera

Department of Social Services and the NSW Department of Family and Community Services, Ageing, Disability and Home Care

The NSS Multicultural Social Support program MSSS provides social support for people from a CALD background who are 65 years of age or younger people with a disability. Service is provided through volunteers who provide social support by assisting clients to medical appointments, shopping, outings, and transport assistance and to group activities. They also support them by providing them with access to social functions, outings and other events organised by the MSSS Coordinators. The coordinators recruit, train, and manage volunteers to provide a quality and reliable service to the program clients from a CALD background.

The Multicultural Social Service (MSSS) supports CALD people in Wyong and Gosford LGA who are frail aged, younger people with disability and carers. There are over 140 clients and 32 volunteers. These volunteers provide support to clients and carers. These can include: home visits, telephone calls, taking clients to medical appointments, shopping, banking, etc. They also support them by taking them to social functions, outings and other events organized by the MSSS Coordinators. The Coordinators cover both local government areas in the Central Coast. The MSSS Coordinators recruit, train and manage volunteers so that they can provide a good and reliable service to the MSSS clients from a CALD background. Adequate and up to date training is offered to volunteers four times a year and the Coordinators are available to supervise volunteers and advise them on issues that concern them.

2014/15 Volunteer Training: Food Handling, Seniors First Aid Certificate, Volunteers and the New World of Community Care and NRMA Safe Driving.

NSS publishes a quarterly MSSS newsletter which provides clients and volunteers with information about the service, such as Government changes, upcoming training, and functions in general, etc.

CLIENTS MONTHLY SOCIAL DAYS

- **First Wednesday:** since February 2015 the Cooking Classes have recommenced and have been very successful. Our clients have had a taste of Chile, Thailand, Brazil, Panama and Ukraine cuisine.
- **Second Wednesday:** the General Group attends the Bateau Bay Office or other organized venues. During 2014-2015 we attended events at Central Coast Leagues Club, Diggers at The Entrance, Saltwater Seafood, Rock & Roll, Christmas Cabaret at The Entrance Leagues Club, Shelley Beach Golf Club and Pelicans Restaurant.
- **Third Wednesday:** the Spanish Speakers Group meets at the Bateau Bay Office. Everyone brings a plate to share, every month a volunteer prepares a show with a different theme. The clients and volunteers are actively involved and have a wonderful time.

- **Three Thursdays of the month** the Woy Woy Group meets at The Peninsula Community Centre. We enjoy craft, movie days, presentations by volunteer Ivan, music, outings to restaurants or parks etc.
- **Last Friday:** Kanwal Group - Kellie coordinated the Kanwal social group for part of the year, and participated in bus outings, arts and crafts and outdoor picnics. MSSS received a Seniors Week grant for March 2015. For Seniors Week 2015, MSSS provided a Multicultural Seniors Week Activity Workshop which ran over three days. This workshop provided a wide variety of activities from Tai Chi, Origami, Arts & Crafts, Live music & entertainment, Chinese dancing, belly dancing, Argentinean dancing and culinary cuisine. Natalia Meliendrez took over in May 2015 with the group enjoying craft, wishing tree activities and cooking. The volunteers are happy to be part of the group and like to participate in all of the activities.

EVENTS AND NETWORKING

- English conversation at Gosford Presbyterian Church to promote NSSS
- Health Expo at Mingara Recreation Centre
- Open Day at Narara Community Centre
- Multicultural Expo at Erina Hall
- Ageing Arts & Craft Expo at the Entrance Community Centre.
- White Ribbon Breakfast at Kooindah Waters Golf Club, Wyong
- White Ribbon Walk at The Entrance
- Sector Innovation Briefing at Mingara Club, session 2 from 11:00 to 12:45
- Presentation at Wyong Hospital to promote MSSS
- Harmony Day at The Entrance
- Access Point Forum at Mingara Club
- Wesley Mission 10 year's celebration breakfast at Tuggerah
- Disaster Response training at Bateau Bay Office
- "Elephant in the Room" conference at Crowne Plaza, Terrigal
- Italian Republic Day Ceremony Flag Raising at Wyong Council

The MSSS team is very busy not only in the coordination of the groups and the organisation and supervision of volunteers but also continuously participating at community events in order to promote the service and recruit volunteers.



Kanwal Craft Group



Chinese Social Support Project

Dongmei Zhang

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

The Chinese Social Support Project (CSSP) aims to provide an appropriate social support program to the frail older people from Chinese background that live in Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens and Maitland local government areas.

The project coordinator role includes establishing and maintaining the social support groups located at 3 local government areas. Training and continuous support for volunteers to provide one to one social support to our senior clients. There are 47 clients registered with the Chinese Social Support Project in the first whole year.

CSSP Highlights

Monthly social support groups were originally formed at Wallsend, Charlestown and East Maitland. In May 2015 we successfully relocated the Wallsend group to Jesmond which was easily accessible by public transport. Activities across these groups include English conversation class (Newcastle), Tai Chi exercises (Charlestown), celebration of special cultural festivals as well as regular outings. Information sessions have been arranged monthly. Topics have included updates from Centrelink, basic skills for your garden, looking after your vision, high blood pressure, Senior's Opal card, Public Housing, introduction of the staff and programs available at the Place Charlestown and Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre. Information about Home Care and Residential Care was presented by Australian Nursing Home Foundation at the end of year 2014 celebration with three groups together. Cantonese and Mandarin speakers made the topic much easier to understand. After the April super storm, StormSafe information sessions were delivered to the three groups. The group members said they would now be better prepared if something happens in the future. Two John Hunter Hospital group tours were organised in June within the Newcastle group.



Above: CSSP clients receiving an information session about Home Care and Residential Care.



Above: CSSP clients visiting John Hunter Hospital

In May a computer class was set up at Charlestown. The group was facilitated by an English speaking volunteer tutor and assisted by a Cantonese speaking volunteer and meet fortnightly. One of this group reported that she can now self-manage her Centrelink account since she built up her confidence from the computer class.

Volunteers

In 2014-2015, volunteers were recruited by the project coordinator, all playing different but vital roles which include English conversation, computer class tutoring, facilitating Tai Chi, telephone based monitoring services and one to one social support to our senior clients. Individual orientation took place for each volunteer including Police Checks. All volunteers are regularly contacted – at least once a month – either by a meeting, phone call or email to maintain communication and support. A special Christmas BBQ lunch was organised for our lovely volunteers. During the National Volunteer Week 2015, all the volunteers received their certification of appreciation from Northern Settlement Services.



Left: CSSP volunteers receiving Certificate of Appreciation during National Volunteer Week 2015

Promotion and Communication

The project coordinator has regularly participated at community events in order to promote the service and recruit volunteers, such as Maitland Riverlight Festival, Multicultural Expo and especially events organised by the Hunter Valley Chinese Association. The most popular being the Chinese New Year celebration.

From February 2015, the CSSP coordinator commenced invitations to group meetings and special events through a popular app used in the Chinese community. Volunteers also use this app to call and message to clients. The app makes communication easy and effective for both clients and coordinator.

Receiving positive feedback from our clients and their families and seeing the meaningful difference the project makes to Chinese seniors' wellbeing and lives provides a great deal of job satisfaction.

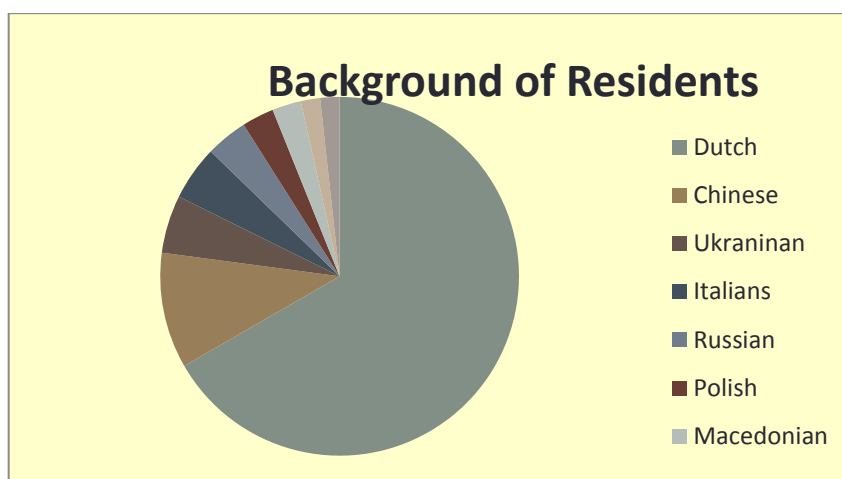


Community Visitors Scheme - Hunter

Irene Lupish

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

This project continues to provide a service to CALD residents of Aged Care Facilities and to those who live at home and are in receipt of Home Care Packages. This program covers areas of Cessnock, Lake Macquarie, Maitland, Newcastle and Port Stephens. During the past 12 months 12 facilities were visited and 31 residents had volunteers attached to them. Those volunteers made 364 visits and travelled 7,823 kilometres. Matching visitors to residents was a challenging task. Residents were of Dutch, Chinese, Italian, Ukrainian, Russian, Polish, Macedonia, Lebanese, Hungarian and Polish background.



To date, there are 16 volunteers registered. During this reporting period 3 volunteers resigned and 5 new volunteers were recruited. New volunteers attended an orientation program and 4 volunteers were successfully matched with residents. This year we have received 6 referrals from facilities and 3 from Home Care Package Providers.

Training and events were organised for the volunteers. In August 2014 training of new volunteers were conducted. This was followed by a Volunteer Week celebration, a cruise lunch was organised in appreciation of work done by the volunteers. In December 2015 a Christmas party was organised with Santa Clause delivering small gifts to those present.

Those residents who receive a visitor are usually very isolated and lonely. Introducing a visitor puts a big smile on their faces, especially when they realise that the visitor can speak their language and have the same cultural background. Residents feel that they are linked to the rest of the community through talking with the volunteer, reading newspapers and sharing their news. Resident and volunteers develop a friendship, which improves their quality of life.



During this year, two regional meetings were held as well as a state conference. These events are always very beneficial as they provide information and support for coordinators. With the big changes that have occurred in the Aged Care sector, these meeting are invaluable.



Community Visitors Scheme - Central Coast

Kellie Matterson

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

Introduction

In July 2014 NSS was successful in securing funding to expand its highly effective Hunter region Community Visitors Scheme (CVS) to the Central Coast. The expansion program focused on Group Visits in Residential Aged care facilities as well as One to One Home visits for people receiving a Home Care Package. Initial funding for 5 residential Group visits and 10 One to One Home visits was increased to 15 Group visits (5 CALD visits and 10 General group visits) in November 2014.

Achievements

From a relatively slow start, due to the challenges described below, the program ended the year with 14 group visits in place - visiting 20 people from diverse cultural and linguistic backgrounds e.g. Polish, Italian, Dutch, German, Greek, Egyptian, Thai, Finnish, Spanish, Czechoslovakian - as well as Australian backgrounds.

As well, 7 One to One home visits were put in place- for people from Chinese, Greek, Dutch, and Italian backgrounds.

As can be seen, both components of the program are well on the way to meeting the performance targets set by the Department. The successful outcomes achieved were due to the concerted and ongoing efforts by the Coordinator in promoting the program, initiating/ developing relationships with facility staff / Packaged Care Coordinators in order to establish effective referral mechanisms.

Challenges

As CVS had previously only targeted one to one visits in residential facilities, implementing these new types of programs presented, and will continue to present, some challenges. Recruiting visitors from appropriate cultural/ linguistic backgrounds in the linguistically diverse/ geographically dispersed area such as the Central Coast is a continuing issue- due to relatively low numbers of potential CALD volunteers to draw on. The slow rate of referrals was in part due to group visits in residential facilities being a new concept. The long waiting time for facility managers to return Client Profiles - needed before a visit could be initiated -was also an issue. As was the fact that many facilities had their own Community Visitors program.

The other major challenge was recruiting visitors who were willing/able to facilitate group visits, often with people of different backgrounds – often requiring a different approach and new strategies by visitors to foster engagement and participation among those attending. The Coordinator sourced and attended training on Diversional Therapy Techniques for Working Effectively in Group Settings- and the knowledge and skills learned were passed onto volunteers. The Coordinator also needed to provide more intensive ongoing monitoring and support to visitors undertaking group visits.

Referrals from Package providers for the One on One Home Visits were also slow in coming due to many Coordinators being too busy converting packages to Consumer Directed Care. As well, people on higher level packages were often too ill for visits..

Community Visitor Recruitment and Turnover

Due to the ongoing turnover of volunteers, recruitment was an on-going process – during the year there were 21 active visitors: 7 in the In Home visiting component and 14 in residential group visits.

Orientation / Support Activities:

Individual orientation took place for new visitors, including Police Checks (and 3 yearly renewals). All visitors were regularly contacted- either by phone, email or mail to maintain communication and support. Training on the topics of: "A New World of Community Care" and "Understanding Dementia"; "Memory Loss" were well attended by volunteers. In addition a morning tea with Certificates of Appreciation were organised to celebrate Volunteer Week and thank volunteers for their valuable contributions.

Networking

CVS Regional Network Meetings were useful avenues for discussing common challenges, sharing experiences/ effective strategies. Feedback from other CVS providers confirms that the challenges we experienced were not unique but were consistent across all providers. Central Coast Disability & Aged Services (CCDA) and other regional forums were also useful networking and promotion opportunities.

Benefits of the Scheme

The principle benefit of the Scheme is that Visitors play an integral role in easing the social and cultural isolation for people living in residential facilities as well as at home. Many may not have family living close by or their extended support networks were left behind as a result of migration or moving to the area, as well as friends experiencing health issues or passing away.

Matching people with a visitor who has similar cultural and language backgrounds continues to be especially important to our target group as people often revert back to their own language with advancing years and the onset of dementia. Having a visitor from a similar cultural background provides an opportunity for residents to maintain a link to the community. The benefits to the visitors are many - their feeling of being valued; new friendships formed or strengthened over the years; the sense of community and the sense of wellbeing – both mentally and physically.

The Coordinator has resigned from her position from 10th July 2015, to take on a role with another organisation. Kellie's commitment, hard work and warm and engaging personal style were instrumental to successfully establishing this new program and achieving the excellent program outcomes outlined above. All her colleagues and friends at NSS wish Kellie well in her future endeavours. The challenge for the coming year and the new Coordinator will be to build on these achievements as well as expanding the program to meet the increased target of 25 group visits at residential facilities as well as one to one Home visits.

Multicultural Family Support & Welfare



Funded
by
Department of Family & Community Services, Community Services

Multicultural Family Support & Welfare

Early Intervention & Placement Prevention (EIPP) Program

**Petrona Kelly (Team Manager), Juanita Purcell-Loli, Elena Ferguson,
Lydia Manusiu, Hayley Bateman**

Funded by

NSW Department of Family & Community Services, Community Services



The service operates predominantly in Newcastle, Lake Macquarie with outreach services provided to locations across the Lower Hunter as capacity allows at Maitland, Cessnock & Port Stephens.

The Early Intervention & Placement Prevention Program (EIPP) targets low to medium risk children, young people and families from Culturally and Linguistically Diverse Backgrounds for short term support to identified issues and prevent escalation of problems. Duration of service could be three months and could be extended to a further three months upon review or to a year if the client is re-assessed as needing continuing service to achieve agreed goals.

This support service model is structured to deliver two streams of service provision:

- Child and Family Support targets families with children aged 0 – 12 years or expectant mothers.
- Youth & Family Support targets young people 12 to under 18 years or families with young people in this age range.

Young people and families may be experiencing a number of vulnerabilities which may include:

- Lack of social support/extended family supports
- Difficulties managing children
- Financial difficulties/poverty
- Cultural barriers/Transitioning
- Homelessness, alcohol and/ or other drug misuse
- Domestic violence
- Education, training, employment
- Justice/safety

The Welfare Team Service Activities include:

- Advice & Referral by providing comprehensive information and advice to young people and families
- Assessment & Case Planning to assess the strengths & needs, including any risks; plan & coordinate a mix of services to meet the needs of clients
- Casework by undertaking activities to implement the case plans of individual clients: information & advice, support, advocacy, referrals to relevant agencies or specialist services, etc.
- Home visits delivered to individual family home or another location

- Counselling to young people and/or families who have been
- Providing practical skills in a group situation
- Providing structured parenting programs through Parenting Skills Groups
- Parent Support Groups Facilitating self-help/peer support groups for parents
- Assistance is also provided to people who have come to Australia more than five years ago as refugees or as humanitarian entrants.

Group Work:

The Welfare Team are responsible for running groups at NSS premises or other locations.

- MOMS (Mothers' Obstetrics Multicultural Support in partnership with Hunter New England Multicultural Health Services being run at Ethnic Communities Council (ECC) in Waratah.
- Raymond Terrace Playgroup at Thou-Walla Family Centre in association with Firstchance
- NSS Multicultural Parenting Group at ECC in Waratah
- Multicultural Supported Playgroup at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC) in Lambton working together with Kindergarten Union (KU), MNC & Mission Australia
- Multicultural Playgroup Lake Macquarie in collaboration with Lake Macquarie City Council & The Willows, held at Uniting Church, Warners Bay
- NSS Parenting Group being run at the Seventh Day Adventist Church, Hamilton
- Woodrising Playgroup, a joint project between Wesley Mission and NSW Community Services at the Woodrising Neighbourhood Centre in Woodrising
- NSS Multicultural Playtime Group in partnership with MNC held at the centre in Lambton.
- Russian Bicultural Children's Group run at Wallsend; It provides Russian-speaking mothers the opportunity to get together and teach their children the Russian language through play, stories, music and other activities while the mothers share their parenting skills in raising bilingual kids.
- Filipino Women's Group – meets monthly at NSS premises.

During the year, Welfare Team provided approximately 2,658 instances of services to clients. Their issues are inter-related in many cases and on many occasions a client/family presented a number of needs/problems.

Issues/Problems Presented By Clients:

Issues/Problems	No of Instances	Issues/Problems	No of Instances
Domestic Violence	275	Legal Matters	215
Settlement Information/General Information	410	Immigration/Citizenship/Sponsorship /Passport Applications/Renewals	210
Health/Mental Health	90	Housing/ Accommodation	100
Youth Issues	100	Education & Training	97
Employment	50	Police Matters	35
Child Support	35	Family problem	255
Income Support/Financial Difficulties	110	Material Assistance (EAPA)	210
Childcare	47	Aged Care	40
		Others	379
		TOTAL	2,658

Other Services Provided to Clients:

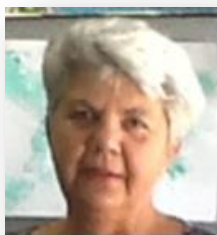
- On-going provision of emergency relief on Electricity (EAPA) and Gas assistance vouchers not only to Culturally and Linguistically Diverse Backgrounds (CALD) clients, but to Anglo Saxons as well who are on low income and are Centrelink recipients. We can also help secure Water assistance for clients by the worker ringing directly Hunter Water Board advocating on their behalf.

Clients Countries of Origin: Philippines, Thailand, Russia, Tonga, Samoa, Fiji, Afghanistan, Iraq, Iran, Sudan, Somalia, India, China, Japan, Spain, Vietnam, Nepal, Burundi, Sierra Leone, Indonesia, Macedonia, Nepal, South Africa, New Zealand, Hong Kong, Malaysia, Germany, France, South Korea, Moldavia, Russia and Australia.

Participation in Events: Welfare Team members helped organised/participated/attended:

- Lake Macquarie Harmony Day celebration, Charlestown
- Singleton Harmony Day celebration
- Cessnock Harmony Day celebration
- White Ribbon Breakfast, West Leagues Club Lambton
- Child Protection Breakfast, New Lambton
- Multicultural Expo, Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre, Lambton
- River Lights Multicultural Festival, Maitland
- Refugee Week celebration,
- Lake Macquarie Family Exhibition, "You Are Kidding Me Expo"

Staff Training: Trainings, workshops, seminars and conferences were available for staff to attend for the opportunity of networking with other services providers from government and non-government agencies for awareness and development.



Multicultural Family Support Project-Families First

Miza Torlakovic

**Funded by Family and Community Services, Community Services -
Families NSW**

Project Description: The Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) specific Family Project under Families NSW provides support to vulnerable disadvantaged families comprising of first time parents and families with children aged 0-8 from CALD backgrounds. The target group includes teenage parents and parents with a developmental disability and/or parents with other special needs who live in the Newcastle and Lake Macquarie LGAs.

Service delivery/ case management:

In the last year 84 families accessed the project, of this, 48 were new clients. The client group varies with no particular dominant migrant or refugee group. Families come from South Korea, Nepal, Russia, Afghanistan, Sudan, China, Iran, Bangladesh, India, Congo, Croatia, Senegal, Bosnia, Italy, Philippines, Uruguay, Chile, Peru, Serbia, Iraq, Israel, Japan, Indonesia, Thailand, Pakistan, Jordan, Kenya, Macedonia, Burundi, Afghanistan, Poland, Vietnam, Qatar and Bolivia.

Referrals mainly come from Hunter Area Health, Centrelink, Women's refuges, Child Care Services, Child and Family Health, Housing services, TAFE, Schools. Referrals also come through community services, other early intervention services as well as through NSS and self-referrals.

928 Face to face case contacts including centre based, home and hospital visits and appointments to and with another agencies/ service providers. Issues addressed included: parenting practices, health and children's health, torture and trauma, child care, school issues, family/ domestic violence, legal issues, Centrelink, material/financial assistance, accommodation, immigration, learning English, social isolation and assistance with filling forms.

1658 emails and telephone contacts were also made in the last year.

Group and Individual Programs:

Throughout the year several group activities were provided and supported. These sessions related to community education and for the purpose of information & social support to CALD families, especially new arrivals.

MOMS (Mothers Obstetrics and Multicultural Support) Friendship group is a partnership with the Multicultural Health Services. 8 Sessions were held on settling babies, kid safety, baby development, mental wellbeing/ post natal exercise, introducing baby food, child speech and language development. 133 people attended with interpreters in Dari/Farsi, Thai, Vietnamese, Korean, Spanish and Mandarin languages used.

Multicultural Parenting Group –

Throughout the year 11 group activities for CALD parents / carers with children were held at the Ethnic Communities Council (ECC) on a monthly basis, with 237 parents/ carers and children attending.

**Multicultural Kindergarten Union (KU) Supported Play Group** is a

partnership with KU, MNC, Mission

Australia and Community Services. 32 playgroup sessions held with 476 parents and children attending. The families enjoyed sharing children's birthdays, BBQ picnics and library visits.

Woodrising Play group - Due to an increase of CALD families attending Woodrising playgroup, the NSS Welfare Team has supported this playgroup on a weekly basis. Six sessions where 177 parents /carers and children attended was supported by the CALD Family Worker.

North Lake Macquarie Play Time Group is a partnership with The Willows Uniting Church, Lake Macquarie City Council & NSS providing a friendly and welcoming place for parents and carers from Culturally and Linguistically Diverse backgrounds living in Lake Macquarie area.

Activities for this group include storytelling, music, singing, games and craft, support and resources for parents and carers, as well as networking. Thirteen sessions with 171 parents / carers and children attended every 1st, 3rd & 5th Wednesday of the month at Warners Bay.

Community Capacity Building:

This project has been involved in coordinating a number of Wellbeing educational sessions in partnership with Multicultural Health Services and the NSS EIPP workers, for emerging communities such as the Afghani background young families, the Russian Community and a Multicultural parenting group. The sessions were held at NSS or ECC premises with interpreters used as needed.

This project also participated in celebrating Children's Week run by Family In Sight alongside with other organizations / services called "Come and Be Loud at Blackbutt". This event took place on 23rd October at Blackbutt Reserve with 250 children and over 400 people in attendance and enjoyed craft, storytelling, sausage sizzle, parachute games and more. During "National Family Week" in May some 180 parents and children attended a family picnic at the Newcastle Foreshore – with hugely positive feedback.

Lake Macquarie "You're Kidding Me Expo" was another success. During the day information about NSS projects, Playgroups especially the one at Warners Bay to around 60 people. Another major and great success was the community event in which the CALD Family Project participated in was the Lake Macquarie Harmony Day Celebration a joint event with members of the Newcastle Multicultural Interagency. Over 300 people enjoyed the Launch of the Lake Macquarie Migrant Stories webpage, international food testing and entertainment.

The project also participated in the Refugee Week Celebration - close to 200 migrant and refugee background families attended the picnic at Jesmond Park. There was a presentation of a variety of sporting activities and entertainment, which was enjoyed by all. The Multicultural Services Expo at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC) was another great event that this project was involved, over 400 people attended.

The CALD Family Worker was invited to present at the launch at SSI of the **'Caring for Children'** booklet, giving a regional perspective of the family work the project delivers.



Networking and other Forums

Much of the success of this project has been due to the worker networking with other organisations. This offered good client outcomes through the project workers and knowledge about specific services through the various agencies partnerships. Attendance at formal meetings, interagency and other forums sharing information on the target group, making appropriate referrals to services has helped develop a strong base on issues that impacts on the new arrival clients. Altogether it has been a busy year with good outcomes for the Families NSW project.



Wellbeing Consultation



Community Builders - Community Development

including Playing around the World

Pari Batha / Natalia Meliendrez

Funded by

**NSW Family and Community Services, Community Services and
Benevolent Society**



This project works to raise the profile of the Central Coast Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) community. This involves working closely with the CALD community, local community leaders, advocates, service providers and other relevant networks. The Project supports the Central Coast CALD Community to participate in general events and facilitates opportunities for members of the CALD community to share their experiences with the wider Central Coast community.

Multicultural Cooking Classes

The Multicultural Cooking Classes assist in connecting the CALD communities on the Central Coast with the mainstream community by teaching participants how to prepare a variety of cultural foods and to share in the preparation and consumption of these. This was undertaken at multiple locations including Green Point Community Centre, Kariang Neighbourhood Centre, Warnervale Family and Community Centre and Gosford / Narara Neighbourhood Centre. The aforementioned Centres have hosted cooking classes from countries, including but not limited to Chile, Argentina, China, Iran, India, the Philippines, Thailand and Uzbekistan. The sessions also promote understanding and valuing of other cultures. Essentially they are an opportunity for those attending to learn about each other's cultural backgrounds, beliefs and way of life. They highlight commonalities as well as differences. Unfortunately, due to funding cuts and changes in management some centres are unable to host the classes in 2015.

Film Global

This project is a direct partnership between NSS, Gosford Council Youth Services (Erina Youth Centre, also known as Erina Hub) and the CALD Community. The project promotes unity, harmony, diversity and general strengthening of branches of our community. The film nights held at Erina Hub have been held monthly with different ethnic communities hosting each evening. Each community group provides food from their mother country and share cultural performances, a cultural display table and a short documentary relating to their ethnicity before the commencement of the evening's film. Groups from the following backgrounds were Indian, Thai, Chinese, French and Iranian. Celebrations were held with special film nights for both Youth Week and Refugee Week. The Gosford Council Youth Services support the group with funding to prepare food. The cost of entry is a gold coin donation.

Mapping ethnic group One of the most important elements of this project commenced at the start of 2015 when it began to research the nature of cultural and religious groupings on the Central Coast. As part of this qualitative and quantitative research, surveys have been undertaken and consultations undertaken with the leaders/representatives of a number of groups including Maori, Fijian, Indian, and Polish.

Community Capacity Building

Harmony Day Celebrations

Gosford Council, Wyong Council and NSS held a Harmony Day celebration at the Entrance Memorial Park, approximately 2000 members of the community attended and participated in the celebrations. NSS had as many 300 pins on the diversity map in the two hours between 10 am and 12 pm. Moreover, the NSS served a variety of sweets from around the world. Our stall was visited by the mayors of both Gosford City and Wyong Shire. We also received a letter of appreciation from Wyong Council and email celebrating the participation and response of CALD communities through the support of NSS. NSS also participated with the Annual Celebrations of Harmony Day at Mary MacKillop Catholic College as has been our practice in the past.

Refugee Day Several Refugee Day celebrations were held on the Coast. This was done in conjunction with the Green Point Community Centre and Gosford Council Youth Services. The Green Point Community Centre celebrations featured a documentary about refugees. A number of guest speakers presented a personal side to being a refugee sharing their personal experiences and those of their loved ones. Additionally we had an Amnesty International stall and a guest speaker to speak on their behalf at each of our events. The film night to coincide with Refugee week was so powerful and made such an impression, that a number of viewers were visibly overwhelmed emotionally by the film and many provided feedback that it impacted on their feelings and responses toward Refugees.

Multicultural Expo In addition to the events outlined above, this project assisted with the Multicultural Expo. The Expo was designed mainly to provide information and understanding relating to Emergency Services. However, we also had stalls from a number of other service providers who were able to provide insights relating to various support services through a number of workshops during the day.

The Central Coast Connect Day Committee was also supported by this project. We provided them with a range of multicultural activities and had representatives from CALD communities attending.

The White Ribbon Breakfast and the Entrance and Terrigal Walks NSS and CALD communities attended proactively by participating in the White Ribbon Breakfast. Likewise representatives attended and participated in the Entrance and Terrigal walk. There was also information sessions relating to Domestic Violence held at Wyong Plaza. We participated in other events including Peninsula Link, the Chinese Festival, the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency and the CALD DV Committee.

Playing Around the World

"The main goal of the Project is to bring families together to share ideas, experience friendship and give children the opportunity to learn through play". Each of the groups join together to link culture and parenting experience and a range of children's activities. Playing around the world takes place at The Entrance Community Centre, Blue Haven Community Centre and Gosford and Narara Community Centre.

Diverse cultural background materials are produced for the children to cover areas such as free play, craft, play dough, dance and music, story time, sensory activities, traditional food and games. The project works in collaboration with workers from different organizations promoting services and programs in running activities to support the mothers for example: holding a cooking class, teaching craft, informing about the importance of using puppets while playing with their children and the benefits for speech development, Uni4 you and so on. Other activities this year included preparing for natural disaster and learning about the women's health centre. The Project participated in school holiday activities in the Wyong Shire and events like Kids Day Out, Harmony Day, the Multicultural Expo, Multicultural Christmas Party and Eat your way Around the World across the Central Coast.

Some families that have children who will be starting school next year have been provided with information about going to school and also some activities for the children based on a reward system.

At our Playing around the World sessions we have parents from: UK, Italy, Greece, China, Hong Kong, Indonesia, Taiwan, Japan, Turkish, Lebanon, Indian, Russia, Ukraine, Uruguay, Spain, Germany, Cook Islands, Fiji, Poland, Ireland, the Philippines, New Zealand and Australia.

The Wyong Multicultural Advisory Committee meeting is where NSS is represented by providing information to this Wyong Council committee about our programs on the Central Coast. In a long year a number of events were organised by the committee and included:

- Harmony Day at The Entrance Memorial Park
- Flag raising ceremony at Wyong Council:
- The Pilipino group celebrated the Independence Day followed by a morning tea.
- Meet the Mayor and TAFE award night
- Multicultural Christmas Party at Toukley Seniors



Brighter Futures Program

Early Intervention Program

Zenaída Edmunds & Desie Erhart

**Funded by
Samaritans**



Northern Settlement Services Brighter Futures (BF) Program provides the home visiting component of the program to CALD families with young children.

Families eligible to be in the program are; families in domestic violence situation, families that are having drugs and alcohol problems and families where one or both parents or carers have mental illness.

Brighter Futures Program is an intensive and preventative program to support vulnerable families with young children up to 8 years of age, where children are considered at risk of significant harm. In Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas, Brighter Futures is delivered by non-government agencies and the lead agency is Samaritans Foundations. This program is voluntary and takes referrals from government and non- government agencies as well as self-referrals.

The support includes referrals to relevant services such as parenting classes, playgroups, counselling, accessing child care, homework support, financial counselling, accommodation, court support and specialist services. Also includes role model positive parenting, positive interactions within the family, provide strategies for parents to use in guiding children's behaviour, establishing routines with the children, preparing healthy and inexpensive meals and lunches for children, building positive relationships within the family. Family's goals are developed by the family with the BF Case Manager and are written in the Family Case Plan, which is reviewed every 3 months to monitor achievements and identify new goals. The family could be in the program for a maximum of 2 years. The role of the home visitor is to provide home visits on a weekly basis and more is needed; to assist the family achieved their goals.

This year 90% of the family we supported are Domestic Violence (DV) cases, it is important to have a well-documented visits because case notes can be subpoenaed during court hearings. One of the BF families we supported was eligible for Complex Case Support from Department of Immigration because some members of the family had some immediate and ongoing health issues, financial issues and complicated by sudden death of a family member. Also, we were able to refer one of the children with disability to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS); this was a much needed support to the family.

We provided home visits to 8 families this year from Afghanistan (2x), Iran, Bangladesh, Japan, Indian, Thailand, and South Korea.

Total No. of Home Visits: **139**

Total No. of Visiting Hours: **296 Hours**

No. of Adults (Parents/Carers) Supported: **31**

Total No. of Children Supported: **38**

Issues Addressed:

Child Care Placement	10
Child Development	35
Playgroup Access	25
Transport	41
Parenting Classes	26
Financial Counselling	11
Behavioural Problems	28
Organising Interpreter	12
Support VISA Inquiry	16
Diet/Nutrition/School Lunches	23
After School Hours/Vacation Care	15
Family Relationship	27
Court Support	25
Social/ Community Participation	18
Housing/Accommodation	22
English Language Support	10
Toilet Training/Information	11
Citizenship Support	5
Establishing Routine	10
Sleeping Pattern Information	15
Safe Rent Subsidy Support	9
Total	394

Activities: Coordinate the running of the Multicultural Playtime Sessions every Friday morning during school term at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre. Provide transport to CALD background families to attend the KU Supported Multicultural Playgroup every Tuesday morning during school term at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre. Provide assistance to the Facilitator of NSS Life Skills and Parenting Support Group every Thursday morning.

Other activities attended during the year included :-Harmony Day Celebration, Multicultural Services Expo, BF Family Fun Day and Refugee Week celebrations.



Parenting & Life Skills

Helen Buchanan
Funded by
Department of Social Services

Throughout this period the project offered refugees, migrants and vulnerable families opportunities to continue to develop life skills & capacity engagement through parenting and cultural development.

Parenting & Life Skills Group Work

The migrant and refugee population is continually changing and this group has provided a much needed gap for several parents who have children with some delays. The mothers have bonded very strongly and support each other tremendously. They often remark that the smaller nurturing nature of this particular group has contributed greatly to their safety and security alongside some of the tremendous developments that we have seen in the children.

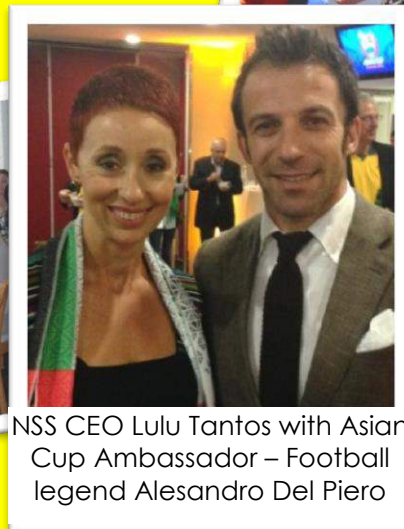
The program is based on the Australian Childhood foundations "Bringing up Great Kids" module. This will now become an official course over the next year to implement with required training.

This program is based on Mindful parenting and is founded in evidence based neuroscience. Interrelate are still very much supporting the group through outreach and attend the group on a monthly basis.

The men's program ran until December, finishing the year with a long awaited community wedding. The wedding planning became part of the group and all were invited along to celebrate.

The Youth Program has been limited in 2015 to school terms due to the availability of the hall facility. However, family picnics and BBQs have been successful at Hamilton and Jesmond Parks during school breaks.

Events NSS has participated in during the year.





Complex Case Support Program

Petrona Kelly

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

Complex Case Support (CCS) provides specialised and intensive case management services to humanitarian entrants with complex and high needs. The program provides flexible, tailored and localised responses to the needs of all individuals in each case.

Northern Settlement Services has a contract with the Department of Immigration and Border Protection to provide these services in Newcastle and the Hunter Region.

CCS is specifically targeted at supporting clients whose needs extend beyond the scope of other settlement services such as the Humanitarian Settlement Services (HSS) and the Settlement Support Program (SSP). CCS is designed to work in partnership with other settlement and mainstream services to address the significant barriers these clients face in settling in Australia.

Complex Needs may include:

- Mental health (including torture and trauma)
- Physical health
- Family violence intervention
- Personal, grief or family relationship counselling
- Special services for children and youth
- Support to manage accommodation, financial or legal issues

Referral to Complex Case Support can be done by any organization or person such as:

- Service providers funded by the department
- Commonwealth, state or territory government agencies
- Community & health organizations
- Local church & community groups
- Volunteer groups
- Self-referrals

What happens to a referral?

The Department of Social Service assesses each referral and decides whether to accept it on a case-by-case basis. Each case that is accepted is allocated to a member of the Humanitarian Services Panel or another contracted service provider. The client is informed whether or not the referral has been accepted.

An Initial Needs Assessment (INA) is completed by the service provider. This is usually done by meeting the client face-to-face and discussing what they regard as their needs and the information in the referral. An INA may also be requested by the department to assist in deciding whether to accept a referral.

A Case Management Plan (CMP) is developed by the service provider for the accepted case. The CMP sets out the activities that will be undertaken to address the key issues identified through the referral and needs assessment of the client/s. Once the department agrees to the CMP, the service provider starts delivering the services through a case manager.

Eligibility: The main client group of CCS are:

- Refugee entrants
- Special Humanitarian Program entrants
- Protection visa holders and persons who hold or have held a Temporary Protection Visa CCS services may be delivered as short as crisis intervention of up to 14 days or as case management services up to six months.
- Clients are eligible for services for up to 5 years after their arrival in Australia, however flexibility may be shown to this timeframe in exceptional circumstances.

This year, NSS received two referrals which are now completed.



Natural Disasters Resilience Strategy, Community Resilience Innovation Program

Katie Sewell – Community Engagement Coordinator

**Funded by
NSW Department of Justice**

The NSW Ministry for Police & Emergency Services (now the department of Justice) provided funding to Northern Settlement Services Ltd, (NSS) through the Community Resilience Innovation Program to deliver a '*Natural Disasters Resilience Strategy (NDRS) for the CALD community in the Hunter Region and the Central Coast*'. NSS is working in partnership with New South Wales State Emergency Services and NSW Rural Fire Service. The NDRS project commenced in March 2015 and will conclude in May 2016.

The NDRS project will develop and implement a comprehensive natural disaster strategy to build resilience in culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) communities across the Hunter Region and Central Coast. The implementation plan will develop a training program for CALD communities, a toolkit of resources and a distribution plan. The plan will include workplace Emergency Response Planning 'checklists' for community leaders adopting the training program.

The NDRS project will bring together agencies and other key stakeholders to work in collaboration to develop a best-practise CALD engagement strategy for building resilience to natural disasters.

An Advisory Group oversees the implementation plan and provides valuable input throughout the project.

Who will benefit?

- CALD Communities of the Hunter and the Central Coast regions.
- Other vulnerable 'at risk' groups including; people aged 75 and over, people with a disability, people who were socially isolated, people with dementia who are living alone and people on low incomes.
- Other specific communities such as regional indigenous communities.
- Service providers who provide a range of vital services during and post natural disasters ranging from emergency accommodation to practical day to day support.
- Other CALD communities will gain through having access to the Hunter and Central Coast CALD community's experiences, tested resources and an adaptable training program.

Why

Newcastle City and the Hunter and Central Coast regions have received considerable increases in migrant and refugee settlement and this is expected to continue into the near future. These new residents do not have the local knowledge and experience in natural hazards and risks and these regions have been subject to a number of recent significant weather experiences including floods, strong wind and fires that have caused severe property damage and left several communities with additional trauma.

In addition, the limited English language skills of this culturally and linguistically diverse sector of the community makes them especially vulnerable in dealing with these events.

How

- The project has developed a strong network of key stakeholders who participate in an advisory or consultative role or both.
- CALD community members will be invited to provide input and feedback during the training program development phase.
- A visual aid resource (DVD) will be produced in partnership with NSW State Emergency Service and NSW Rural Fire Service that can be used during workshops and shared through various social media sites.
- A number of pilot workshops will be delivered to CALD community members and service providers throughout the Central Coast and Hunter regions covering; preparedness, response and recovery from natural disasters.
- Emergency Response Planning agency 'checklist' guidelines will be developed to assist community leaders in developing their own plans.
- A range of multilingual resources will be developed to assist CALD community members these include magnets with key contacts, Apps and websites and pictorial evacuation flip cards to be used by the New South Wales State Emergency Service and NSW Rural Fire Service when evacuating families from their homes.

A methodology and evaluation process will ensure the data captured during this project is statistically robust and meaningful.



Left: April East Coast Low 'Super Storm'
Maitland – Hunter Region 22.4.15
Source: 1233 ABC Newcastle



Above: April East Coast Low 'Super Storm'
Brisbane Water Tascott– Central Coast 21.4.15
Source: The Daily Telegraph

Official Partners – Natural Disasters Resilience Strategy, Community Resilience Innovation Program



Photo: NSW Rural Fire Service – The Lakes Team Inspector Scott Pollard, New South Wales State Emergency Service – Hunter Region Amanda Hyde & Northern Settlement Services Ltd. – Katie Sewell. (Photo courtesy of Inspector Shane Geerin NSW Rural Fire Service – The Lakes Team. 12.8.15)

Hunter Region Non-Government Organisation Managers / CEO's Natural Disaster Forum held at NSW Rural Fire Service Cameron Park 13th October 2015.



Photo: Melissa Gore Regional Executive Officer and Disaster Welfare Manager Hunter New England - NSW Family and Community Services presenting at the Hunter Region Non-Government Organisation Managers / CEO's Natural Disaster Forum at NSW Rural Fire Service Cameron Park.



Funded by the Commonwealth and NSW Governments under the Community Resilience Innovation Program.



Refugee Week 2015

Irene Lupish

**Funded by Multicultural NSW and
Northern Settlement Services Ltd**

The Newcastle and Hunter Refugee Week 2015 celebrations took place between June 13th – June 21st. The theme for the region was “Yesterday, Today and Tomorrow.” The “Yesterday” event of the celebration was a reunion of Greta Migrant Camp ex-residents.

It was 65 years since the arrival of migrants/refugees to the camp. It was a three day celebration. On Friday the 13th of June an appropriate film was shown to a full capacity hall. The official opening was by the Mayor of Cessnock, Cllr. Bob Pynsent. This was followed by speeches made by prominent people in front of hundreds of participants. The local Polish community and the Northern Settlement Services choir provided entertainment. Those present were invited to travel to the site of the original Greta migrant camp by cars or the mini buses provided.

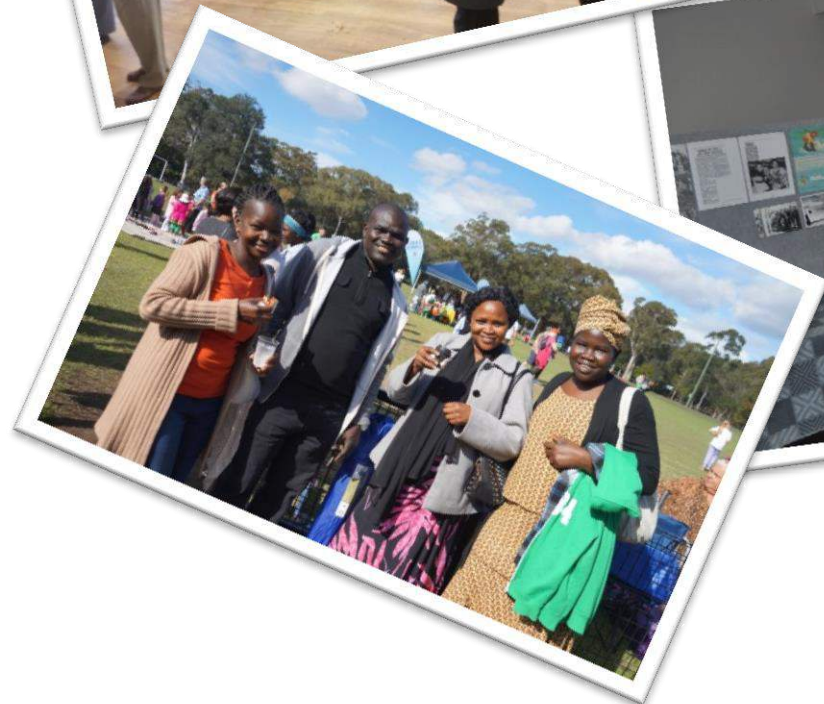
Available on sale were bottles of wine with commemorative label, historical book called “Greta”, paintings and postcards. Greta Workers Club provided a venue for an exhibition of memorabilia, photographs, Greta Camp model and an electronic historical display of “Life in the Camp”. This exhibition was open for three days – Friday, Saturday and Sunday.

Celebrations extended beyond Greta to other regions of the Hunter – to Newcastle city, Port Stephens and Lake Macquarie under the banner of “Yesterday, Today and Tomorrow”. In Newcastle celebrations were showcased by participation of newly arrived refugees, showcasing local Refugee talents by showing films produced not only by professionals but also by local refugee youth. Films were shown on the 16th and 20th of June. On the 14th June, a picnic was organised in recognition and acknowledgement of the contribution that refugees have made to the region.

In Port Stephens the community celebrated Refugee Week 2015 by organising a one day historical exhibition showing the regions historical connection to the refugee's arrival since 1943. There were speeches, entertainment and luncheon. Representatives of the former immigrants at Fly Point attended and Chance Yeow, a former East Timorese refugee from the Bobs Farm Cadre Camp, shared his experiences as a refugee.

In Lake Macquarie Cultural Art Displays were organised at the Lake Macquarie Art gallery focusing on “Today and Tomorrow”. Cultural Art Displays including African Fashion, Food tasting, Hair Braiding, Acrobatics, Henna Painting and Children's Parliament were enjoyed by many. All events were coordinated by the Northern Settlement Services Ltd with support of Community Relations Commission, many organisations, local councils, local businesses and individuals. Events were covered by local media.

Refugee Week 2015 Activities



Immigration Advice & Assistance





Immigration Advice & Assistance

Lulu Tantos, & Henriette de Jong
(Reg.#0318123) (Reg.#1462231)



Northern Settlement Services (NSS) has been operating a dedicated immigration advice and assistance service for over 20 years to clients in the Newcastle, the Hunter area and in the regional areas of NSW. Our registered Migration Agents provide professional, up to date advice and assistance to ensure that the immigration process goes as smoothly as possible for our clients. Immigration law is complex with many different visas being available depending on our clients' circumstances.

We assist in:

- Temporary residence options
- Permanent visa options
- Humanitarian and Protection visa applications
- Appeals to the AAT and the Minister

During the last financial year approximately 570 clients from diverse backgrounds were seen and over 500 instances of phone advice were given by our Migration Agents. 130 of the clients seen were applying for humanitarian visas. The Migration Agents have dealt with clients from Afghanistan, Australia, China, DR Congo, Ethiopia, India, Iran, Iraq, Nigeria, Philippines, Sudan, Thailand and the Ukraine.

The majority of clients applying for humanitarian visas were from Afghanistan. As is a common pattern, the most recently arrived refugee community lodge applications mostly for humanitarian visas for family remaining overseas. A number of applications for family visas were also lodged by this group and other members of refugee communities.

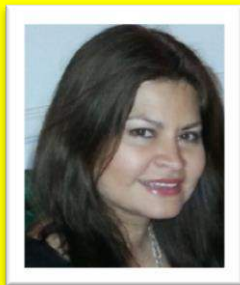
From October 2014 regular monthly appointments with a Migration Agent were provided to residents of the Central Coast at our NSS office in Bateau Bay. From November 2014 a migration advice outreach service has been provided in Orange, Bathurst, Dubbo, Tamworth, Armidale and the mid North Coast. Migration information has been provided as education for service providers and presentations to groups of clients. A Skype service is being established to enable clients in those areas to have an appointment with a Migration Agent in Newcastle.



Photo above:- NSS worker Violeta Klements proudly displaying her Australian Citizenship certificate at the recent Lake Macquarie City Council Citizenship ceremony, alongside NSS CEO Lulu Tantos and Lake Macquarie Council Lord Mayor Jodie Harrison.

Finance & Administration Team Newcastle & Central Coast

As at 30th June 2015

		
Enza Di Stefano Operations Manager	Kerry Blades Finance Manager	Kathy Rowarth Assistant Finance Officer
		
John Pattey Senior Administration Officer	Natasha Holliday Administration Officer	Violeta Klements Administration Officer (Maternity Relief)
		
Keiko Clements Office Manager Central Coast	Sharlene Huber Administration Officer Central Coast	Helen Buchanan WH&S Officer

Financial Statements



Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Annual Report - 30 June 2015

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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30 June 2015

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Northern Settlement Services Limited Directors' report 30 June 2015

The directors present their report, together with the financial statements, on the company for the year ended 30 June 2015.

Directors

The following persons were directors of the company during the whole of the financial year and up to the date of this report, unless otherwise stated:

Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM
Zoran Vasiljevic
Sania Young
Fr Nicholas Zervas OAM
Biko Syongoh
Christine Jordan
Anna Marendy
James Garvey
Irina Lupish (resigned 16 July 2014)
Jon Chin
Denise Hodgson PSM (appointed 20 August 2014)
Georgina Ramsay (appointed 26 November 2014)
Ewa Korczynski (appointed 26 November 2014)

Principal activities

During the financial year the principal continuing activities of the company consisted of:

- providing welfare and information services.

Short and long term objectives

Northern Settlement Services has developed a strategic plan with objectives, strategies and indicators to guide and monitor the work of the organisation. The short and long term objectives are achieved through leadership, support and advocacy for culturally and linguistically diverse communities of the Hunter, Central Coast and New England regions of New South Wales. In this way, the organisation can continue to develop programs and activities across areas that are responsive to member needs.

Operating result

The surplus of the company for the financial year amounted to \$407,095 (2014: restated surplus of \$472,742). Please refer to note 4 regarding the restatement of the 2014 results as required by Australian Accounting Standards.

Information on directors

Name:

Experience and expertise:

Special responsibilities:

Name:

Experience and expertise:

Special responsibilities:

Name:

Experience and expertise:

Special responsibilities:

Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM

Retired

- Director Hunter Health – Migrant Health Unit
- Regional Co-ordinator NSW Ethnic Affairs Commission
- Nurse Counsellor- Working Women's Centre
- Current Board Member of Tinonee Gardens Multicultural Village

Director, Chair, Audit Committee

Zoran Vasiljevic

Practicing solicitor

- Over 14 years solicitor in Australia
- 14 years lawyer/solicitor in Yugoslavia
- Bosnian community representative

Director

Sania Young

Extensive aged care experience – enrolled nurse

- Diploma in Community Development
- Diploma in Social Science
- Diploma of Librarian
- Tartar Community Representative

Director

Northern Settlement Services Limited Directors' report 30 June 2015

Name:	Fr Nicholas Zervas OAM
Experience and expertise:	Priest of the Greek Community of Newcastle since 1973 • Life member of Ethnic Communities Council of Newcastle and Hunter- Greek Community Representative • Meals on Wheels- Volunteer 20 years • Fronditha Aged Care Nursing Home- Life member
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Biko Syongoh
Experience and expertise:	Practicing solicitor • Bachelor of Communication • Bachelor of Laws • African Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Christine Jordan
Experience and expertise:	Retired • Bachelor of Social Services • Over 20 years in Child Protection • Juvenile Justice • Nursing- General/Psych, Aged and Disability • Resettlement Officer for Newly Arrived Migrants (Red Cross) • Polish Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director, Treasurer, Audit Committee & Public Officer
Name:	Anna Marendy
Experience and expertise:	Retired • Founding member and life member of Fronditha Aged Care Nursing Home • Greek Community Representative – over 25 years volunteer with Hippocrates Assoc.
Special responsibilities:	Director, Company Secretary
Name:	James Garvey
Experience and expertise:	• Local Businessman • Bachelor of Science, Business and Administration • Real Estate Construction Management- University of Denver
Special responsibilities:	Director, Assistant Treasurer, Audit Committee
Name:	Irina Lupish
Experience and expertise:	Retired • Former migration agent • Russian Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director, Vice Chair
Name:	Jon Chin
Experience and expertise:	Local Businessman • Extensive experience working with Board in the Club industry
Special responsibilities:	Director, Vice Chair
Name:	Denise Hodgson PSM
Experience and expertise:	Retired • Assoc. Diploma of Social Welfare and Bachelor of Social Science • Over 20 years with the Public Service specialising in Multicultural Access
Special responsibilities:	Director, Assistant Secretary

Northern Settlement Services Limited Directors' report 30 June 2015

Name:	Georgina Ramsay
Experience and expertise:	Sessional Academic, Lecturer and Tutor at The University of Newcastle • Phd in Sociology and Anthropology • Experience in Volunteer Coordination- Welfare Programs, Homework Centre Coordinator
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Ewa Korczynski
Experience and expertise:	• Community Options Unit Service Director- Hunter New England Health for over 20 years • Bachelor of Applied Science- Hon.; Grad. Diploma of Welfare Law • Volunteer crew member on James Craig the tall ship (Sydney Maritime Museum) and volunteer with Dog Rescue Newcastle
Special responsibilities:	Director

Company secretary

The following person held the position of company secretary at the end of the financial year:

Sania Young is the representative of the Tartar Community and was appointed Company Secretary on 21 April 2010.

Meetings of directors

The number of meetings of the company's Board of Directors ('the Board') held during the year ended 30 June 2015, and the number of meetings attended by each director were:

	Full Board	
	Attended	Held
Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM	7	10
Zoran Vasiljevic	6	10
Sania Young	7	10
Fr Nicholas Zervas OAM	8	10
Biko Syongoh	4	10
Christine Jordan	7	10
Anna Marendy	4	10
James Garvey	7	10
Irina Lupish	1	1
Jon Chin	9	10
Denise Hodgson PSM	7	7
Georgina Ramsay	5	5
Ewa Korczynski	5	5

Held: represents the number of meetings held during the time the director held office.

Indemnifying officer or auditor

During the year, the company effected a directors and officers liability policy. The insurance policy provides cover for the directors named in this report, the company secretary, officers and former directors and officers of the company. This policy prohibits the disclosure of the nature of the indemnification, the insurance cover and the amount of the premium.

No indemnities have been given or insurance premiums paid, during or since the end of the financial year, for any person who is or has been an auditor of the company.

Contributions on winding up

In the event of the company being wound up, ordinary members are required to contribute a maximum of \$10 each.

The total amount that members of the company are liable to contribute if the company is wound up is \$380, based on 38 current ordinary members.

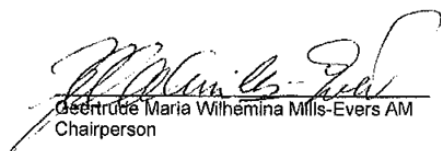
Northern Settlement Services Limited
Directors' report
30 June 2015

Auditor's independence declaration

A copy of the auditor's independence declaration is set out on the following page.

This report is made in accordance with a resolution of directors.

On behalf of the directors



Gertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM
Chairperson

18 November 2015



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**INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S DECLARATION
TO THE MEMBERS OF NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED**

We hereby declare that to the best of our knowledge and belief during the year ended 30 June 2015, there have been:

- (i) no contraventions of the auditor independence requirements as set out in the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012* in relation to the audit; and
- (ii) no contraventions of any applicable code of professional conduct in relation to the audit.

Name of Firm

Bishop Collins Audit Pty Ltd
Chartered Accountants

Name of Registered Company Auditor


Martin Le Marchant

Auditor's Registration No.

431227

Address

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue, Tuggerah NSW 2259

Dated

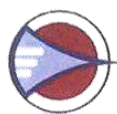
18 November 2015



LIABILITY LIMITED BY A SCHEME APPROVED UNDER THE PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS LEGISLATION



Registered Company Auditors: David A McClelland CA, Glenn A Harris CA, Martin Le Marchant CA



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INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED

Report on the Financial Report

We have audited the accompanying financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited which comprises the statement of financial position as at 30 June 2015, statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income, statement of changes in equity and statement of cash flows for the year ended on that date, notes comprising a summary of significant accounting policies and other explanatory information and the responsible entities declaration.

Directors' Responsibility for the Financial Report

The directors of the company are responsible for the preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards and the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012* and for such internal control as the directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view and is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

Auditor's Responsibility

Our responsibility is to express an opinion on the financial report based on our audit. We conducted our audit in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards. Those standards require that we comply with relevant ethical requirements relating to audit engagements and plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial report is free from material misstatement.

An audit involves performing procedures to obtain audit evidence about the amounts and disclosures in the financial report. The procedures selected depend on the auditor's judgment, including the assessment of the risks of material misstatement of the financial report, whether due to fraud or error. In making those risk assessments, the auditor considers internal control relevant to the company's preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the company's internal control. An audit also includes evaluating the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates made by the directors, as well as evaluating the overall presentation of the financial report.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinion.

Independence

In conducting our audit, we have complied with the independence requirements of the *Corporations Act 2001* and the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012*.



LIABILITY LIMITED BY A SCHEME APPROVED UNDER THE PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS LEGISLATION



Registered Company Auditors

David A McClelland FCA

Glenn A Harris CA

Martin Le Marchant CA



Basis for Qualified Opinion

The financial report for the year ended 30 June 2014 of Northern Settlement Services Limited was audited by another auditor whose report dated 16 October 2014 expressed an unmodified opinion on that financial report. In conducting the audit for the year ended 30 June 2015, we were unable to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence in respect of comparatives and opening balances in the financial report.

Qualified Opinion

In our opinion, except for the possible effects of the matter described in the Basis for Qualified Opinion paragraph, the financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited is in accordance with Division 60 of the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012*, including:

- (a) giving a true and fair view of the company's financial position as at 30 June 2015 and of its performance and cash flows for the year ended on that date; and
- (b) complying with Australian Accounting Standards - Reduced Disclosure Requirements (including the Australian Accounting Interpretations) and the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Regulation 2013*.

Name of Firm

Bishop Collins Audit Pty Ltd
Chartered Accountants

Name of Registered Company Auditor


Martin Le Marchant

Auditor's Registration No.

431227

Address

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue, Tuggerah NSW 2259

Dated

18 November 2015

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income
For the year ended 30 June 2015

	Note	2015 \$	2014 \$
Revenue	5	3,336,803	3,129,581
Other income	6	39,040	-
Expenses			
Advertising expenses		(3,556)	(3,958)
Auditor's remuneration		(22,875)	(22,250)
Computer expenses		(15,844)	(13,572)
Consultancy expenses		-	(56,263)
Depreciation and amortisation expense		(59,527)	(58,253)
Employee benefits expense		(1,922,278)	(1,655,765)
Facilities and cleaning expenses		(46,935)	(21,644)
Finance costs		(18,486)	(18,378)
Insurance expenses		(32,877)	(37,178)
Motor vehicle expenses		(38,912)	(40,655)
Printing, postage and stationery expenses		(30,012)	(27,115)
Program expenses		(105,997)	(29,145)
Office expenses		(17,171)	(8,164)
Service expenses		(378,923)	(409,926)
Training and travelling expenses		(53,138)	(70,097)
Utilities expenses		(63,037)	(57,541)
Volunteer expenses		(24,814)	(21,134)
Other expenses		(134,366)	(105,801)
Surplus before income tax expense		407,095	472,742
Income tax expense		-	-
Surplus after income tax expense for the year attributable to the members of Northern Settlement Services Limited	19	407,095	472,742
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax		-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year attributable to the members of Northern Settlement Services Limited		<u>407,095</u>	<u>472,742</u>

The above statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of financial position
As at 30 June 2015

	Note	2015 \$	2014 \$
Assets			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	7	1,566,685	1,974,681
Trade and other receivables	8	234,208	186,624
Held-to-maturity investments	9	750,483	-
Other current assets	10	3,169	20,148
Total current assets		<u>2,554,545</u>	<u>2,181,453</u>
Non-current assets			
Property, plant and equipment	11	1,038,753	928,231
Intangibles	12	-	1,925
Total non-current assets		<u>1,038,753</u>	<u>930,156</u>
Total assets		<u>3,593,298</u>	<u>3,111,609</u>
Liabilities			
Current liabilities			
Trade and other payables	13	178,640	145,029
Borrowings	14	38,991	37,837
Employee benefits	15	235,223	208,800
Other current liabilities	16	56,849	23,174
Total current liabilities		<u>509,703</u>	<u>414,840</u>
Non-current liabilities			
Borrowings	17	236,935	271,893
Employee benefits	18	50,784	36,095
Total non-current liabilities		<u>287,719</u>	<u>307,988</u>
Total liabilities		<u>797,422</u>	<u>722,828</u>
Net assets		<u>2,795,876</u>	<u>2,388,781</u>
Equity			
Retained surpluses	19	<u>2,795,876</u>	<u>2,388,781</u>
Total equity		<u>2,795,876</u>	<u>2,388,781</u>

The above statement of financial position should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of changes in equity
For the year ended 30 June 2015

	Retained surplus \$	Total equity \$
Balance at 1 July 2013	1,916,039	1,916,039
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	348,646	348,646
Prior period restatement	4 124,096	124,096
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax	-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year	472,742	472,742
Balance at 30 June 2014	2,388,781	2,388,781
	Retained surplus \$	Total equity \$
Balance at 1 July 2014	2,388,781	2,388,781
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	407,095	407,095
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax	-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year	407,095	407,095
Balance at 30 June 2015	2,795,876	2,795,876

The above statement of changes in equity should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of cash flows
For the year ended 30 June 2015

	Note	2015 \$	2014 \$
Cash flows from operating activities			
Receipts from customers (inclusive of GST)		3,479,539	3,175,273
Payments to suppliers (inclusive of GST)		(3,014,767)	(2,968,650)
		464,772	206,623
Interest received		61,014	52,720
Interest and other finance costs paid		(18,486)	(18,378)
Net cash from operating activities		507,300	240,965
Cash flows from investing activities			
Payments for investments		(750,483)	-
Payments for property, plant and equipment		(177,377)	(2,431)
Payments for intangibles		-	(1,925)
Proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment		39,368	2,615
Net cash used in investing activities		(881,492)	(1,741)
Cash flows from financing activities			
Proceeds from borrowings		18,936	-
Repayment of borrowings		(52,740)	(36,057)
Net cash used in financing activities		(33,804)	(36,057)
Net increase/(decrease) in cash and cash equivalents		(407,996)	203,167
Cash and cash equivalents at the beginning of the financial year		1,974,681	1,771,514
Cash and cash equivalents at the end of the financial year	7	1,566,685	1,974,681

The above statement of cash flows should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 1. General information

The financial statements cover Northern Settlement Services Limited as an individual entity. The financial statements are presented in Australian dollars, which is Northern Settlement Services Limited's functional and presentation currency.

Northern Settlement Services Limited is a not-for-profit unlisted public company limited by guarantee.

The financial statements were authorised for issue, in accordance with a resolution of directors, on 18 November 2015.

Note 2. Significant accounting policies

The principal accounting policies adopted in the preparation of the financial statements are set out below. These policies have been consistently applied to all the years presented, unless otherwise stated.

New, revised or amending Accounting Standards and Interpretations adopted

The company has adopted all of the new, revised or amending Accounting Standards and Interpretations issued by the Australian Accounting Standards Board ('AASB') that are mandatory for the current reporting period.

Any new, revised or amending Accounting Standards or Interpretations that are not yet mandatory have not been early adopted.

Basis of preparation

These general purpose financial statements have been prepared in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards - Reduced Disclosure Requirements and Interpretations issued by the Australian Accounting Standards Board ('AASB'), and the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012, as appropriate for not-for profit oriented entities.

Historical cost convention

The financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost convention, except for, where applicable, the revaluation of available-for-sale financial assets, financial assets and liabilities at fair value through profit or loss, investment properties, certain classes of property, plant and equipment and derivative financial instruments.

Critical accounting estimates

The preparation of the financial statements requires the use of certain critical accounting estimates. It also requires management to exercise its judgement in the process of applying the company's accounting policies. The areas involving a higher degree of judgement or complexity, or areas where assumptions and estimates are significant to the financial statements, are disclosed in note 3.

Revenue recognition

Revenue is recognised when it is probable that the economic benefit will flow to the company and the revenue can be reliably measured. Revenue is measured at the fair value of the consideration received or receivable.

Sale of goods

Sale of goods revenue is recognised at the point of sale, which is where the customer has taken delivery of the goods, the risks and rewards are transferred to the customer and there is a valid sales contract. Amounts disclosed as revenue are net of sales returns and trade discounts.

Rendering of services

Rendering of services revenue is recognised by reference to the stage of completion of the contracts.

Stage of completion is measured by reference to labour hours incurred to date as a percentage of total estimated labour hours for each contract. Where the contract outcome cannot be reliably estimated, revenue is only recognised to the extent of the recoverable costs incurred to date.

Interest

Interest revenue is recognised as interest accrues using the effective interest method. This is a method of calculating the amortised cost of a financial asset and allocating the interest income over the relevant period using the effective interest rate, which is the rate that exactly discounts estimated future cash receipts through the expected life of the financial asset to the net carrying amount of the financial asset.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Grants

Non reciprocal grants are recognised as income when the grant is received. Reciprocal grant income is recognised in accordance with the criteria specified in the grant agreement. Where this cannot be reliably estimated, revenue is only recognised to the extent of the recoverable costs incurred to date, with the remainder carried forward in the statement of financial position.

Other revenue

Other revenue is recognised when it is received or when the right to receive payment is established.

Income tax

As the company is a charitable institution in terms of subsection 50-5 of the Income Tax Assessment Act 1997, as amended, it is exempt from paying income tax.

Current and non-current classification

Assets and liabilities are presented in the statement of financial position based on current and non-current classification.

An asset is classified as current when: it is either expected to be realised or intended to be sold or consumed in normal operating cycle; it is held primarily for the purpose of trading; it is expected to be realised within 12 months after the reporting period; or the asset is cash or cash equivalent unless restricted from being exchanged or used to settle a liability for at least 12 months after the reporting period. All other assets are classified as non-current.

A liability is classified as current when: it is either expected to be settled in normal operating cycle; it is held primarily for the purpose of trading; it is due to be settled within 12 months after the reporting period; or there is no unconditional right to defer the settlement of the liability for at least 12 months after the reporting period. All other liabilities are classified as non-current.

Cash and cash equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents includes cash on hand, deposits held at call with financial institutions, other short-term, highly liquid investments with original maturities of three months or less that are readily convertible to known amounts of cash and which are subject to an insignificant risk of changes in value.

Trade and other receivables

Trade receivables are initially recognised at fair value and subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method, less any provision for impairment. Trade receivables are generally due for settlement within 30 days.

Collectability of trade receivables is reviewed on an ongoing basis. Debts which are known to be uncollectable are written off by reducing the carrying amount directly. A provision for impairment of trade receivables is raised when there is objective evidence that the company will not be able to collect all amounts due according to the original terms of the receivables. Significant financial difficulties of the debtor, probability that the debtor will enter bankruptcy or financial reorganisation and default or delinquency in payments (more than 60 days overdue) are considered indicators that the trade receivable may be impaired. The amount of the impairment allowance is the difference between the asset's carrying amount and the present value of estimated future cash flows, discounted at the original effective interest rate. Cash flows relating to short-term receivables are not discounted if the effect of discounting is immaterial.

Other receivables are recognised at amortised cost, less any provision for impairment.

Investments and other financial assets

Investments and other financial assets are initially measured at fair value. Transaction costs are included as part of the initial measurement, except for financial assets at fair value through profit or loss. They are subsequently measured at either amortised cost or fair value depending on their classification. Classification is determined based on the purpose of the acquisition and subsequent reclassification to other categories is restricted.

Financial assets are derecognised when the rights to receive cash flows from the financial assets have expired or have been transferred and the company has transferred substantially all the risks and rewards of ownership.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Held-to-maturity investments

Held-to-maturity investments include non-derivative financial assets with fixed or determinable payments and fixed maturities where the company has the positive intention and ability to hold the financial asset to maturity. This category excludes financial assets that are held for an undefined period. Held-to-maturity investments are carried at amortised cost using the effective interest rate method adjusted for any principal repayments. Gains and losses are recognised in profit or loss when the asset is derecognised or impaired.

Impairment of financial assets

The company assesses at the end of each reporting period whether there is any objective evidence that a financial asset or group of financial assets is impaired. Objective evidence includes significant financial difficulty of the issuer or obligor; a breach of contract such as default or delinquency in payments; the lender granting to a borrower concessions due to economic or legal reasons that the lender would not otherwise do; it becomes probable that the borrower will enter bankruptcy or other financial reorganisation; the disappearance of an active market for the financial asset; or observable data indicating that there is a measurable decrease in estimated future cash flows.

Property, plant and equipment

Land is measured at cost. Buildings are measured at cost less accumulated depreciation and impairment losses. Valuations are performed by external independent valuers at least every 3 years. The valuations are undertaken more frequently if there is a material change in the fair value relative to the carrying amount. Any accumulated depreciation at the date of revaluation is eliminated against the gross carrying amount of the asset and the net amount is restated to the revalued amount of the asset. Increases in the carrying amounts arising on revaluation of land and buildings are credited in other comprehensive income through to the revaluation surplus reserve in equity. Any revaluation decrements are initially taken in other comprehensive income through to the revaluation surplus reserve to the extent of any previous revaluation surplus of the same asset. Thereafter the decrements are taken to profit or loss.

Plant and equipment is stated at historical cost less accumulated depreciation and impairment. Historical cost includes expenditure that is directly attributable to the acquisition of the items.

Depreciation is calculated on a straight-line basis to write off the net cost of each item of property, plant and equipment (excluding land) over their expected useful lives as follows:

Buildings	40 years
Leasehold improvements	3-10 years
Plant and equipment	4-10 years
Motor vehicles	2-5 years

The residual values, useful lives and depreciation methods are reviewed, and adjusted if appropriate, at each reporting date.

Leasehold improvements and plant and equipment under lease are depreciated over the unexpired period of the lease or the estimated useful life of the assets, whichever is shorter.

An item of property, plant and equipment is derecognised upon disposal or when there is no future economic benefit to the company. Gains and losses between the carrying amount and the disposal proceeds are taken to profit or loss. Any revaluation surplus reserve relating to the item disposed of is transferred directly to retained profits.

Intangible assets

Intangible assets acquired as part of a business combination, other than goodwill, are initially measured at their fair value at the date of the acquisition. Intangible assets acquired separately are initially recognised at cost. Indefinite life intangible assets are not amortised and are subsequently measured at cost less any impairment. Finite life intangible assets are subsequently measured at cost less amortisation and any impairment. The gains or losses recognised in profit or loss arising from the derecognition of intangible assets are measured as the difference between net disposal proceeds and the carrying amount of the intangible asset. The method and useful lives of finite life intangible assets are reviewed annually. Changes in the expected pattern of consumption or useful life are accounted for prospectively by changing the amortisation method or period.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Website

Significant costs associated with the development of the revenue generating aspects of the website, including the capacity of placing orders, are deferred and amortised on a straight-line basis over the period of their expected benefit, being their finite life of 10 years.

Impairment of non-financial assets

Goodwill and other intangible assets that have an indefinite useful life are not subject to amortisation and are tested annually for impairment, or more frequently if events or changes in circumstances indicate that they might be impaired. Other non-financial assets are reviewed for impairment whenever events or changes in circumstances indicate that the carrying amount may not be recoverable. An impairment loss is recognised for the amount by which the asset's carrying amount exceeds its recoverable amount.

Recoverable amount is the higher of an asset's fair value less costs of disposal and value-in-use. The value-in-use is the present value of the estimated future cash flows relating to the asset using a pre-tax discount rate specific to the asset or cash-generating unit to which the asset belongs. Assets that do not have independent cash flows are grouped together to form a cash-generating unit.

Trade and other payables

These amounts represent liabilities for goods and services provided to the company prior to the end of the financial year and which are unpaid. Due to their short-term nature they are measured at amortised cost and are not discounted. The amounts are unsecured and are usually paid within 30 days of recognition.

Borrowings

Loans and borrowings are initially recognised at the fair value of the consideration received, net of transaction costs. They are subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method.

Where there is an unconditional right to defer settlement of the liability for at least 12 months after the reporting date, the loans or borrowings are classified as non-current.

Finance costs

Finance costs attributable to qualifying assets are capitalised as part of the asset. All other finance costs are expensed in the period in which they are incurred.

Employee benefits

Short-term employee benefits

Liabilities for wages and salaries, including non-monetary benefits, annual leave and long service leave expected to be settled within 12 months of the reporting date are measured at the amounts expected to be paid when the liabilities are settled.

Other long-term employee benefits

The liability for annual leave and long service leave not expected to be settled within 12 months of the reporting date are measured as the present value of expected future payments to be made in respect of services provided by employees up to the reporting date using the projected unit credit method. Consideration is given to expected future wage and salary levels, experience of employee departures and periods of service. Expected future payments are discounted using market yields at the reporting date on national government bonds with terms to maturity and currency that match, as closely as possible, the estimated future cash outflows.

Fair value measurement

When an asset or liability, financial or non-financial, is measured at fair value for recognition or disclosure purposes, the fair value is based on the price that would be received to sell an asset or paid to transfer a liability in an orderly transaction between market participants at the measurement date; and assumes that the transaction will take place either: in the principal market; or in the absence of a principal market, in the most advantageous market.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Fair value is measured using the assumptions that market participants would use when pricing the asset or liability, assuming they act in their economic best interests. For non-financial assets, the fair value measurement is based on its highest and best use. Valuation techniques that are appropriate in the circumstances and for which sufficient data are available to measure fair value, are used, maximising the use of relevant observable inputs and minimising the use of unobservable inputs.

Goods and Services Tax ('GST') and other similar taxes

Revenues, expenses and assets are recognised net of the amount of associated GST, unless the GST incurred is not recoverable from the tax authority. In this case it is recognised as part of the cost of the acquisition of the asset or as part of the expense.

Receivables and payables are stated inclusive of the amount of GST receivable or payable. The net amount of GST recoverable from, or payable to, the tax authority is included in other receivables or other payables in the statement of financial position.

Cash flows are presented on a gross basis. The GST components of cash flows arising from investing or financing activities which are recoverable from, or payable to the tax authority, are presented as operating cash flows.

Commitments and contingencies are disclosed net of the amount of GST recoverable from, or payable to, the tax authority.

Note 3. Critical accounting judgements, estimates and assumptions

The preparation of the financial statements requires management to make judgements, estimates and assumptions that affect the reported amounts in the financial statements. Management continually evaluates its judgements and estimates in relation to assets, liabilities, contingent liabilities, revenue and expenses. Management bases its judgements, estimates and assumptions on historical experience and on other various factors, including expectations of future events, management believes to be reasonable under the circumstances. The resulting accounting judgements and estimates will seldom equal the related actual results. The judgements, estimates and assumptions that have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities (refer to the respective notes) within the next financial year are discussed below.

Provision for impairment of receivables

The provision for impairment of receivables assessment requires a degree of estimation and judgement. The level of provision is assessed by taking into account the recent sales experience, the ageing of receivables, historical collection rates and specific knowledge of the individual debtors financial position.

Fair value measurement hierarchy

The company is required to classify all assets and liabilities, measured at fair value, using a three level hierarchy, based on the lowest level of input that is significant to the entire fair value measurement, being: Level 1: Quoted prices (unadjusted) in active markets for identical assets or liabilities that the entity can access at the measurement date; Level 2: Inputs other than quoted prices included within Level 1 that are observable for the asset or liability, either directly or indirectly; and Level 3: Unobservable inputs for the asset or liability. Considerable judgement is required to determine what is significant to fair value and therefore which category the asset or liability is placed in can be subjective.

The fair value of assets and liabilities classified as level 3 is determined by the use of valuation models. These include discounted cash flow analysis or the use of observable inputs that require significant adjustments based on unobservable inputs.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 3. Critical accounting judgements, estimates and assumptions (continued)

Estimation of useful lives of assets

The company determines the estimated useful lives and related depreciation and amortisation charges for its property, plant and equipment and finite life intangible assets. The useful lives could change significantly as a result of technical innovations or some other event. The depreciation and amortisation charge will increase where the useful lives are less than previously estimated lives, or technically obsolete or non-strategic assets that have been abandoned or sold will be written off or written down.

Employee benefits provision

As discussed in note 2, the liability for employee benefits expected to be settled more than 12 months from the reporting date are recognised and measured at the present value of the estimated future cash flows to be made in respect of all employees at the reporting date. In determining the present value of the liability, estimates of attrition rates and pay increases through promotion and inflation have been taken into account.

Note 4. Restatement of comparatives

Prior period restatement

Subsequent to the release of the 30 June 2014 financial report, the board of directors identified errors in the measurement and presentation of certain line items in the comparative financial statements.

At 30 June 2014 unearned grant funding revenue of \$111,407 was disclosed as a current liability. However the company had satisfied the funding conditions relating to this grant in the financial years prior to balance date. As a consequence, this revenue should have been included in the results of a prior financial year.

At 30 June 2014 employee benefits liabilities of \$42,927 had been classified as non-current. However these entitlements were due and payable within 12 months of balance date in accordance with Australian Accounting Standard AASB 119 'Employee Benefits'.

These errors resulted in the restatement of the following line items for the year ended 30 June 2014:

- revenue increased by \$124,096;
- operating surplus increased by \$124,096;
- cash and cash equivalents decreased by \$2,760;
- trade and other receivables increased by \$5,523;
- trade and other payables decreased by \$9,926;
- current employee benefits increased by \$42,927;
- non-current employee benefits decreased by \$42,927; and
- other current liabilities decreased by \$111,407.

Statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income

Extract	2014 \$ Reported	\$ Adjustment	2014 \$ Restated
Revenue			
Revenue	3,005,485	124,096	3,129,581
Surplus before income tax expense	348,646	124,096	472,742
Income tax expense	-	-	-
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	348,646	124,096	472,742

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 4. Restatement of comparatives (continued)

Statement of financial position at the beginning of the earliest comparative period

When there is a restatement of comparatives, it is mandatory to provide a third statement of financial position at the beginning of the earliest comparative period, being 1 July 2013. However as there was no adjustments made as at 1 July 2013, the company has elected not to show the 1 July 2013 statement of financial position.

	2014 \$ Reported	\$ Adjustment	2014 \$ Restated
Extract			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	1,977,441	(2,760)	1,974,681
Trade and other receivables	181,101	5,523	186,624
Total current assets	2,178,690	2,763	2,181,453
Current liabilities			
Trade and other payables	154,955	(9,926)	145,029
Employee benefits	165,873	42,927	208,800
Other current liabilities	134,581	(111,407)	23,174
Total current liabilities	493,246	(78,406)	414,840
Non-current liabilities			
Employee benefits	79,022	(42,927)	36,095
Total non-current liabilities	350,915	(42,927)	307,988
Net assets	2,264,685	124,096	2,388,781
Equity			
Retained surpluses	2,264,685	124,096	2,388,781
Total equity	2,264,685	124,096	2,388,781

Note 5. Revenue

	2015 \$	2014 \$
<i>Sales revenue</i>		
Grant funding	2,924,090	2,844,187
Service income	165,443	57,762
SSI hosting fees	89,782	87,678
Donations received	8,067	859
	3,187,382	2,990,486
<i>Other revenue</i>		
Interest	61,014	52,720
Other revenue	88,407	86,375
	149,421	139,095
Revenue	3,336,803	3,129,581

Note 6. Other income

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Net gain on disposal of property, plant and equipment	39,040	-

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 7. Current assets - cash and cash equivalents

	2015	2014
	\$	\$
Cash on hand and at bank	<u>1,566,685</u>	<u>1,974,681</u>

Note 8. Current assets - trade and other receivables

	2015	2014
	\$	\$
Trade receivables	208,508	151,834
Other receivables	<u>25,700</u>	<u>34,790</u>
	<u>234,208</u>	<u>186,624</u>

Note 9. Current assets - held-to-maturity investments

	2015	2014
	\$	\$
Term deposits	<u>750,483</u>	<u>-</u>

Note 10. Current assets - other current assets

	2015	2014
	\$	\$
Prepayments	3,169	17,355
Other current assets	<u>-</u>	<u>2,793</u>
	<u>3,169</u>	<u>20,148</u>

Note 11. Non-current assets - property, plant and equipment

	2015	2014
	\$	\$
Land and buildings - at cost	934,196	934,196
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(108,130)</u>	<u>(84,867)</u>
	<u>826,066</u>	<u>849,329</u>
Leasehold improvements - work in progress	84,417	-
Leasehold improvements - at cost	45,090	45,090
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(45,090)</u>	<u>(44,721)</u>
	<u>84,417</u>	<u>369</u>
Plant and equipment - at cost	241,667	205,198
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(205,150)</u>	<u>(154,331)</u>
	<u>36,517</u>	<u>50,867</u>
Motor vehicles - at cost	146,741	240,925
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(54,988)</u>	<u>(213,259)</u>
	<u>91,753</u>	<u>27,666</u>
	<u>1,038,753</u>	<u>928,231</u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 12. Non-current assets - intangibles

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Website - at cost	-	1,925

Note 13. Current liabilities - trade and other payables

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Trade payables	91,518	35,665
BAS payable	12,924	33,353
Other payables	74,198	76,011
	<u>178,640</u>	<u>145,029</u>

Note 14. Current liabilities - borrowings

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Bank loans	38,991	37,837

Note 15. Current liabilities - employee benefits

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Annual leave	86,533	72,551
Long service leave	148,690	136,249
	<u>235,223</u>	<u>208,800</u>

Note 16. Current liabilities - other current liabilities

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Revenue received in advance	56,849	23,174

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 17. Non-current liabilities - borrowings

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Bank loans	236,935	271,893

Total secured liabilities

The total secured liabilities (current and non-current) are as follows:

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Bank loans	275,926	309,730

Financing arrangements

Unrestricted access was available at the reporting date to the following lines of credit:

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Total facilities		
Bank loans	397,092	430,884
Used at the reporting date		
Bank loans	275,926	309,730
Unused at the reporting date		
Bank loans	121,166	121,154

Note 18. Non-current liabilities - employee benefits

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Long service leave	50,784	36,095

Note 19. Equity - retained surpluses

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Retained surpluses at the beginning of the financial year	2,388,781	1,916,039
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	407,095	348,646
Prior period restatement	-	124,096
Retained surpluses at the end of the financial year	2,795,876	2,388,781

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 20. Auditors' remuneration

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Audit services- financial statements	14,350	18,315
Audit of grant funding acquittals	2,000	5,600
Other services	7,800	4,875
	<u>24,150</u>	<u>28,790</u>

The auditor of Northern Settlement Services Limited is Bishop Collins Audit Pty Limited (2014: Cutcher & Neale).

Note 21. Key management personnel disclosures

Compensation

The aggregate compensation made to members of key management personnel of the company is as set out below:

	2015 \$	2014 \$
Aggregate compensation	<u>148,310</u>	<u>197,728</u>

The directors of Northern Settlement Services Limited received no compensation for services provided to the company.

Note 22. Commitments

	2015 \$	2014 \$
<i>Lease commitments - operating</i>		
Committed at the reporting date but not recognised as liabilities, payable:		
Within one year	<u>-</u>	<u>8,280</u>
	<u>2015 \$</u>	<u>2014 \$</u>
<i>Capital commitments</i>		
Committed at the reporting date but not recognised as liabilities, payable:		
Within one year	<u>130,720</u>	<u>-</u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2015

Note 23. Related party transactions

Key management personnel

Disclosures relating to key management personnel are set out in note 21.

Transactions with related parties

A company controlled by the CEO's son, supplied computer equipment and IT services to Northern Settlement Services Limited on normal commercial terms and conditions no more favourable than those available to other persons unless stated.

Receivable from and payable to related parties

There were no trade receivables from or trade payables to related parties at the current and previous reporting date.

Loans to/from related parties

There were no loans to or from related parties at the current and previous reporting date.

Note 24. Events after the reporting period

No matter or circumstance has arisen since 30 June 2015 that has significantly affected, or may significantly affect the company's operations, the results of those operations, or the company's state of affairs in future financial years.

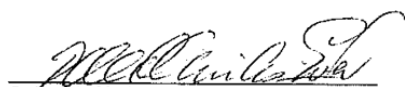
Northern Settlement Services Limited
Directors' declaration
30 June 2015

In the directors' opinion:

- the attached financial statements and notes comply with Australian Accounting Standards - Reduced Disclosure Requirements (including the Australian Accounting Interpretations) and the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012;
- the attached financial statements and notes give a true and fair view of the company's financial position as at 30 June 2015 and of its performance for the financial year ended on that date; and
- there are reasonable grounds to believe that the company will be able to pay its debts as and when they become due and payable.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of directors.

On behalf of the directors


Gertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM
Chairperson

18 November 2015